PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #1 · TRUSTING OTHERS · MISTRUST

"I can't let my guard down."

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Are you having problems trusting others? Do you feel anxious and suspicious about their motives? Do you fear letting your guard down? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward trusting others and find the peace that comes from knowledge of God's word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Feeling betrayed, bullied, deceived, or mistreated can result in a person being more or less constantly alert and anxious. You may find you spend a great deal of your time scanning your environment, looking out for possible threats. Unpredictable relationships, traumatic events, repeated criticism, or messages that nobody can be trusted may strengthen these expectations. The message you may be hearing is: "Don't let down, or something dreadful might happen." Or, you might hear yourself thinking: "People just can't be trusted."

How the belief can keep itself going

Expecting harm can lead to scanning for threats, withdrawing, testing people, or responding defensively. Those responses may reduce opportunities to learn that some relationships are dependable. The task is to compare expectations with present evidence while preserving appropriate boundaries.

What Scripture teaches

God invites us to put our trust in Him when we are afraid, rather than letting fear determine every relationship. Scripture also describes the goodness of companionship, receiving help, carrying one another's burdens, and loving each other. These passages challenge the expectation that closeness can bring only harm. With God's help, I can make room for people who show care and reliability, accept support, and discover that I do not have to face life alone.

> *"Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight"* (Proverbs 3:5–6).

Also see

> "When I am afraid, I put my trust in You. In God, whose word I praise— in God I trust. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?" (Psalm 56:3–4).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ" (Galatians 6:2).

> "This is My commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you" (John 15:12).

Common self-statements

- People always have a hidden agenda.
- If someone is kind, they probably want something.
- I must watch for every sign of betrayal.
- If I relax, I will miss the danger.
- I cannot tell anyone what I really think.
- Depending on someone gives them power to hurt me.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Applying one person's betrayal to all people.
- Mind reading: Treating a guess about someone's motives as a known fact.
- Selective attention: Noticing signs of danger while overlooking consistent, respectful behavior.
- Emotional reasoning: Taking the feeling of being unsafe as proof of a present threat.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Assuming my only choices are complete trust or complete distrust.
- Catastrophizing: Predicting serious harm from an ordinary interaction without enough evidence.

Challenging questions

- What happened that I can directly observe, and what meaning have I added?
- What evidence supports my concern? What evidence points another way?
- Am I responding to this person's behavior or to an earlier betrayal?
- What are two other possible explanations?
- Has this person respected a clear boundary before?
- What small amount of trust, if any, fits the evidence?
- Can I protect myself without assuming that everyone intends harm?

Truth summary

> I can trust God with my fears and allow caring people to become part of my life. Past betrayal does not determine what every new relationship will be. Some people are dependable, and I can learn to recognize and receive their care. I can take small steps toward connection, ask for help, and let trust grow through shared experience.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Help
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Communication
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Trust in You — lyric video



Trust in You — Lauren Daigle

An invitation to trust God even when circumstances feel uncertain.

'Tis So Sweet to Trust in Jesus — lyric video



'Tis So Sweet to Trust in Jesus — Alan Jackson

Encourages resting in Christ's promises and learning to trust Him.

He Will Hold Me Fast — lyric video



He Will Hold Me Fast — Keith & Kristyn Getty

Reassurance of Christ's faithful care when fear makes trust difficult.

I Am Not Alone — lyric video



I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe

Reassures me of God's faithful presence, helping me face fear without feeling that I must handle everything alone.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call paranoid personality disorder. This original educational example uses cognitive restructuring, checking interpretations, and modest behavioral experiments. It is informed by the cognitive model of personality beliefs; it is not a DSM criterion, a quotation from Beck, or a validated treatment protocol.

Beck Institute: Beliefs in personality disorders · Beck, Davis, & Freeman (Eds.), Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders (3rd ed.)

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't let my guard down"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't let my guard down." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What facts do I know, and what am I assuming?
- ☐ What evidence does not fit my fear?
- ☐ What else could explain this person's behavior?
- ☐ Is an old experience shaping my expectation?
- ☐ What boundary would help me make a measured choice?
- ☐ What small step fits this person's actual track record?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ When I am afraid, I can put my trust in God.
- ☐ I do not have to face every difficulty alone.
- ☐ Some people will respond to me with kindness and care.
- ☐ I can receive help without assuming there is a hidden motive.
- ☐ Past betrayal does not mean every relationship will end in betrayal.
- ☐ I can allow trust to grow through small experiences of dependable care.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 3:5–6**
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight."
- ☐ **Psalm 56:3–4**
  "When I am afraid, I put my trust in You. In God, whose word I praise— in God I trust. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?"
- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 4:9–10**
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"

- [ ] Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- [ ] John 15:12
  "This is My commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Trust and support log: Each day, record one time someone showed kindness, kept a promise, listened, or offered help. Describe what I allowed myself to receive and what I learned.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  For example, a personalized adaptation of Psalm 56:3 (based on BSB) is: "When Sarah is afraid, she puts her trust in You."
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

Choose a modest, ordinary situation. These exercises do not require revealing private information or approaching anyone who has threatened, coerced, or abused you. A respectful response is useful evidence; a boundary violation is useful evidence too.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- [ ] Accept one small offer of help. Choose a person who has shown reliability. Accept ordinary help, such as help with a task, and notice what actually happens.
- [ ] Ask someone to listen. Tell a caring friend about a modest everyday concern and ask for a few minutes of listening. Compare their actual response with what I predicted.
- [ ] Make room for companionship. Invite a dependable friend to a short walk, coffee, or another comfortable shared activity. Notice moments of warmth or connection.
- [ ] Acknowledge dependable care. Thank someone for a specific way they have supported me. Write down how it feels to recognize and receive that care.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Review what you learned; bring this page to counseling if you are attending.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie “I can't let my guard down”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Care or support I received
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't let my guard down.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, when I am afraid, help me put my trust in You. Heal the hurts that have taught me to expect betrayal. Help me recognize people who show kindness and faithfulness, receive their support, and take small steps toward friendship. Teach me to give and receive love, and remind me that I do not have to carry every burden alone. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #2 · TRUSTING OTHERS · SUSPICION OF MOTIVES

"Friendliness usually hides an ulterior motive."

✦ ✦ ✦

Are you having problems accepting help from friends or significant others in your life? Do you tend to mistrust their motives or positive intentions? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward trusting the helpful words or actions given by friends, spouses, or others. The objective is to accept the fact that at least some friendly advice can be a positive influence in your life, and is consistent with God's word as revealed in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Past manipulation, broken promises, betrayal, or inconsistent care may teach a person to question friendly behavior. These experiences can make caution understandable. But the mind may start treating a possible motive as a proven motive—even when someone is simply being kind.

How the belief can keep itself going

When friendliness is seen as a trap, a person may pull away, question compliments, or test others. A guarded response can make interactions tense, leaving fewer chances to discover genuine care. A better approach is to observe behavior over time and use reasonable boundaries.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture encourages wisdom and careful listening, but also love, hope, and attention to what is true. Trusting God does not require blind trust in every person. It allows us to examine evidence without assuming that all kindness is dishonest.

> *"Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight." (Proverbs 3:5–6)*

Also see

> "It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things." (1 Corinthians 13:7)

> "Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think on these things." (Philippians 4:8)

> "My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger," (James 1:19)

> "He who answers a matter before he hears it—this is folly and disgrace to him." (Proverbs 18:13)

Common self-statements

- They're being nice because they want something.
- No one is friendly without a reason.
- A compliment is probably a trap.
- If I accept help, I'll owe them.
- I need to figure out what they really want.

- People only pretend to care.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming you know a person's hidden intentions.
- Jumping to conclusions: Deciding friendliness is manipulation without enough evidence.
- Overgeneralization: Treating some past dishonest people as proof about everyone.
- Confirmation bias: Remembering suspicious moments and discounting genuine kindness.
- Emotional reasoning: Mistaking a feeling of distrust for proof of danger.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Assuming kindness must be completely sincere or completely fake.

Challenging questions

- What did this person actually say or do?
- What evidence suggests an ulterior motive? What evidence does not?
- Could ordinary kindness explain the same behavior?
- Am I judging this person by someone else's past actions?
- Has this person respected a boundary or accepted a 'no'?
- What would a balanced, cautious interpretation sound like?
- What small response would let me learn more without risking too much?

Truth summary

Some people may have selfish motives, but many acts of friendliness are genuine. I can respond with courtesy, observe patterns, and maintain appropriate boundaries. I do not need to assume the worst before I have evidence. I can ask God for wisdom and choose a measured response.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Protection
- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Communication
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. A YouTube link is provided as a fallback.

The Same Love
Paul Baloche

Reflect on love that welcomes and restores, rather than assuming every caring gesture conceals a selfish motive.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Rehearse examples of faithful goodness instead of attending only to possible betrayal.

No Longer Slaves
Jonathan David & Melissa Helser

Let assurance of belonging to God loosen the fear that turns ordinary kindness into a perceived threat.

Trust in God
Elevation Worship feat. Chris Brown

Practice resting in God's faithfulness while remaining open to receiving sincere care from others.

Official lyric videos with words on screen. Songs play inside the card; YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call paranoid personality disorder. This educational example uses CBT methods: checking evidence, generating alternative interpretations, and trying low-risk behavioral experiments. Suspiciousness may be associated with paranoid personality patterns, but a single belief is not a diagnostic test. Avoid experiments with people who have threatened, exploited, or abused you.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What evidence do I have about this person's motives, and how can I respond wisely today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Friendliness usually hides an ulterior motive."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Friendliness usually hides an ulterior motive." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when suspicion appears.

- ☐ What did this person actually say or do?
- ☐ What evidence suggests an ulterior motive? What evidence does not?
- ☐ Could ordinary kindness explain the same behavior?
- ☐ Am I judging this person by someone else's past actions?
- ☐ Has this person respected a boundary or accepted a 'no'?
- ☐ What would a balanced, cautious interpretation sound like?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Kindness may be genuine; I can look at the evidence.
- ☐ I do not have to know someone's motives immediately.
- ☐ I can be friendly while keeping sensible boundaries.
- ☐ A compliment does not automatically create an obligation.
- ☐ I can wait for patterns of behavior before deciding.
- ☐ God calls me to wisdom, not constant suspicion.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Proverbs 3:5–6
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 13:7
  "It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things."
- ☐ Philippians 4:8
  "Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think on these things."

- [ ] James 1:19
  “My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger,”
- [ ] Proverbs 18:13
  “He who answers a matter before he hears it—this is folly and disgrace to him.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Trust. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ When a familiar person offers a small courtesy, say thank you without trying to guess their motive. Later, note what actually happened.
- ☐ Accept a minor, no-strings-attached kindness from someone with a history of respecting your boundaries. Record whether a demand followed.
- ☐ Offer a small kindness to another person with no expectation of repayment. Reflect on how kindness can be genuine.
- ☐ For one week, record both examples of sincere kindness and examples of self-interest. Compare the whole pattern.
- ☐ When someone compliments you, write down three possible explanations—including a sincere one—before deciding.
- ☐ Set a polite boundary ('No, thank you') and notice whether the person respects it. Do not test someone who has been unsafe.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about trusting God and treating people fairly.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Friendliness usually hides an ulterior motive.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I can recognize genuine kindness through evidence and time, while keeping healthy boundaries.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Proverbs 3:5–6

A short prayer

Lord, help me notice what is true instead of assuming what others intend. Give me wisdom to recognize danger, courage to receive sincere kindness, and love that does not rush to judge. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #3 · TRUSTING OTHERS · HIDING THE REAL ME

"I need to hide the real me in order to not get hurt."

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Deep down, do you fear that others, if they got to know you, would hurt, ridicule, or make fun of you? Because of this, do you hide your real feelings or the real you? The information below is intended to help you lessen your fear of others by trusting in God's love and care for you as expressed in the Bible. You don't need to hide from God and, with God's help, you can start to be more open and trusting with other people.

Where it often comes from

If honesty was met with ridicule, rejection, punishment, or betrayal, hiding may once have felt protective. A person may learn to show only a polished version of themselves. Over time, a response to particular experiences can become a rule: being known always leads to being hurt.

How the belief can keep itself going

Hiding feelings, agreeing when we disagree, and pretending to be fine can reduce anxiety briefly. But others have fewer opportunities to understand or support us. Feeling unseen can then seem to prove that closeness is impossible. Small, chosen moments of honesty can help us learn whether a trustworthy person responds with care.

What Scripture teaches

God knows us deeply and invites us to approach Him with confidence. His acceptance gives us a foundation for living more honestly. Scripture also calls believers to welcome one another and share burdens. These passages invite connection; they do not promise that every person will respond well or require us to share everything with everyone.

> *"O LORD, You have searched me and known me. You know when I sit and when I rise; You understand my thoughts from afar." (Psalm 139:1–2)*

Also see

> "Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge. Selah" (Psalm 62:8)

> "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need." (Hebrews 4:16)

> "Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you, in order to bring glory to God." (Romans 15:7)

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ." (Galatians 6:2)

Common self-statements

- If people really knew me, they would use it against me.
- I must look strong and keep my struggles hidden.
- My honest feelings will drive people away.
- It is safer to be what others expect.
- I should say I am fine even when I need support.
- Being known means losing control.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Turning past rejection into a rule about all relationships.
- Fortune telling: Treating a feared hurt as certain before it happens.
- Mind reading: Assuming people would reject the real me without checking.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must either hide everything or reveal everything.
- Emotional reasoning: Taking the feeling of vulnerability as proof that I am unsafe.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing experiences of being accepted when I was honest.

Challenging questions

- What part of myself am I afraid to show, and what do I predict will happen?
- Am I assuming this person will react like someone who hurt me before?
- Who has already responded with kindness when I was honest?
- Does keeping everything hidden protect me, or also leave me lonely?
- Can I share one small, ordinary truth instead of everything at once?
- Could someone disagree with me and still care about me?
- How might God's knowledge and acceptance of me change this rule?

Truth summary

I do not have to hide all of myself to be worthy of love or to build meaningful relationships. God knows me and welcomes me. I can allow people who have shown care and respect to know me gradually. Honesty cannot guarantee that I will never be hurt, but hiding everything also has a cost. I can be authentic and still choose healthy boundaries.

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for knowing me and inviting me close. Help me release the need to appear perfect. Give me courage to be honest, wisdom about whom to trust, and openness to receiving love. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Communication
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Known
Tauren Wells

Reflect on being fully known and loved by God rather than needing to keep your real self hidden.

Truth Be Told
Matthew West & Carly Pearce

Challenge the pressure to pretend that everything is fine and consider one honest request for support.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Practice approaching God with your hurts and needs rather than waiting until you look perfect.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Let belonging to God support an identity that does not depend on maintaining a protective image.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call paranoid personality disorder. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Hiding the self can occur with suspiciousness, shame, social anxiety, or past relational injury; it is not specific to a personality disorder. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Psychological difficulties have multiple contributing factors. Sharing personal information is a choice; experiments should involve ordinary, low-stakes honesty with someone who has shown respect.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What small part of the real me can I express honestly today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I need to hide the real me in order to not get hurt."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I need to hide the real me in order to not get hurt." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you feel you must hide.

- ☐ What part of myself am I afraid to show, and what do I predict will happen?
- ☐ Am I assuming this person will react like someone who hurt me before?
- ☐ Who has already responded with kindness when I was honest?
- ☐ Does keeping everything hidden protect me, or also leave me lonely?
- ☐ Can I share one small, ordinary truth instead of everything at once?
- ☐ Could someone disagree with me and still care about me?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I can be known and still be loved.
- ☐ My feelings and needs do not make me unworthy of care.
- ☐ I can choose what to share, with whom, and when.
- ☐ Some people can respond to honesty with kindness and respect.
- ☐ I can let trust grow through small experiences of being real.
- ☐ God knows me deeply; I do not need a perfect image to approach Him.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Psalm 139:1–2
  "O LORD, You have searched me and known me. You know when I sit and when I rise; You understand my thoughts from afar."
- ☐ Psalm 62:8
  "Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge. Selah"
- ☐ Hebrews 4:16
  "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."
- ☐ Romans 15:7

"Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you, in order to bring glory to God."

☐ Galatians 6:2
"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Trust. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ With a person who has respected you, express a small preference instead of automatically agreeing. Predict their response, then record what they actually do.
- ☐ When a trusted friend asks how you are, share one ordinary feeling, such as being tired or a little worried. Notice whether they listen with care.
- ☐ Ask a reliable person for a small favor. Compare what you predicted with the response you received.
- ☐ Admit a minor, everyday mistake to a kind person. Notice whether being imperfect prevents connection.
- ☐ Tell a trusted person about a harmless interest or opinion you usually keep hidden. Look for evidence of curiosity, acceptance, or respectful disagreement.
- ☐ Write an honest prayer about a feeling you hide. Then consider one small part you might choose to share with a trustworthy person.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being known, accepted, and honest.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I need to hide the real me in order to not get hurt.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I can be known and loved. I can show the real me gradually to people who have earned my trust.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Psalm 139:1–2

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for knowing and loving me. Help me practice honest connection today, receive kindness, and remember that I do not have to appear perfect to be worthy of care. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #4 · TRUSTING OTHERS · HIDDEN INTENTIONS

"People always try to hide what they are doing"

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you often suspect that people are hiding their real intentions or planning something they will not tell you about? Does this leave you constantly on guard, looking for clues for their true intentions? The information below can help you separate what you know from what you fear, ask clear questions, and find peace in God's care while allowing trust to grow through honest relationships.

Where it often comes from

Believing that you have been deceived, betrayed, or surprised by someone's harmful actions can teach you to expect that they are communicating hidden plans or meanings. Family secrecy, unpredictable behavior, or repeated warnings about other people can strengthen the belief that you must always search beneath the surface to find people's true meanings or intentions. Even ordinary privacy or an incomplete explanation may then feel like evidence of deception--even without a solid basis for this belief.

How the belief can keep itself going

Expecting concealed intentions can lead to checking, repeatedly questioning people, or replaying conversations for clues. Checking may briefly ease anxiety, but it can make uncertainty feel harder to tolerate. Another person's discomfort with repeated questioning may then seem to confirm the original suspicion. Pausing, asking one respectful question, and comparing predictions with observable behavior can interrupt this cycle.

What Scripture teaches

God invites us to bring our worries to Him and receive His peace. We are not required to uncover every private thought or predict every action. Love makes room for patience and hope, and faithful friendship can grow through experience. Trusting God helps us respond to what is actually happening instead of treating every unanswered question as proof of deception.

> *"When I am afraid, I put my trust in You." (Psalm 56:3)*

Also see

> "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You." (Isaiah 26:3)

> "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you." (1 Peter 5:7)

> "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity." (Proverbs 17:17)

> "It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things." (1 Corinthians 13:7)

Common self-statements

- They are keeping something from me.
- If I stop watching, they will catch me off guard.
- There must be another reason they are doing this.
- I need to work out what they are really planning.
- A vague answer means they are deceiving me.
- I cannot relax until I know their true intentions.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming I know an intention that has not been stated.
- Overgeneralization: Turning past deception into an expectation about everyone.
- Jumping to conclusions: Treating incomplete information as proof of a hidden plan.
- Confirmation bias: Looking for clues that support suspicion while dismissing openness.
- Catastrophizing: Predicting harm whenever I do not know someone's plans.
- Emotional reasoning: Treating anxiety as evidence that deception is occurring.

Challenging questions

- What did I directly observe, and what intention am I guessing?
- Does missing information necessarily mean deliberate deception?
- Could privacy, distraction, uncertainty, or a change of plans explain this?
- What consistent actions support a more trusting interpretation?
- Can I ask one clear question without accusing or repeatedly checking?
- What would I do differently if I could tolerate not knowing everything?

Truth summary

I cannot know every thought or plan another person has. Uncertainty and ordinary privacy do not prove deception. I can ask clear questions, notice consistent actions, and allow reliable people to earn my trust. I can place my anxiety in God's care without constantly searching for hidden intentions.

A short prayer

Father, help me separate what I see from what I fear. Calm the urge to search for hidden motives. Give me patience to listen, courage to ask kindly, and peace to leave unanswered questions with You. Help me recognize and receive honest care. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Wisdom
- Truth

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Communication
- Judgmental
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Whom Shall I Fear (God of Angel Armies)
Chris Tomlin

Practice placing fear in God's care instead of feeling responsible for anticipating every threat.

Peace Be Still
Hope Darst

Reflect on receiving peace when uncertainty makes you anxious.

Just Be Held
Casting Crowns

Consider releasing the pressure to keep everything under your control.

Be Still
Hillsong Worship

Pause the search for hidden intentions and focus on God's faithful presence.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call paranoid personality disorder. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Generalized distrust can follow betrayal, trauma, or abuse and may occur with anxiety, depression, or other conditions; it is not specific to a personality disorder. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Psychological difficulties have multiple contributing factors. Distrust can be reasonable when someone is unsafe; experiments should be low-stakes, and anyone in an abusive or dangerous situation should seek safety and professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

> *Each morning ask: "Can I respond to today's facts with patience and trust, without trying to uncover every hidden thought?"*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People always try to hide what they are doing"

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "People always try to hide what they are doing" I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you suspect someone is hiding a plan.

- ☐ What did I directly observe, and what intention am I guessing?
- ☐ Does missing information necessarily mean deliberate deception?
- ☐ Could privacy, distraction, uncertainty, or a change of plans explain this?
- ☐ What consistent actions support a more trusting interpretation?
- ☐ Can I ask one clear question without accusing or repeatedly checking?
- ☐ What would I do differently if I could tolerate not knowing everything?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Not knowing everything does not prove that someone is deceiving me.
- ☐ A person can have privacy without intending harm.
- ☐ I can ask once, listen carefully, and return to my own activities.
- ☐ Consistent actions are better evidence than guesses about motives.
- ☐ I can tolerate some uncertainty and still make sensible choices.
- ☐ God cares for me; I do not need to monitor everyone's plans.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Psalm 56:3
  "When I am afraid, I put my trust in You."
- ☐ Isaiah 26:3
  "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You."
- ☐ 1 Peter 5:7
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."
- ☐ Proverbs 17:17
  "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity."

☐ 1 Corinthians 13:7
“It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Trust. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Read your Truth Card three times daily and memorize your chosen verse. Set a phone or watch reminder, or place a note where you will see it. Listen to one song daily and record the truth you want to practice.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ In an ordinary interaction with a reliable person, write the observable facts separately from your guess about their intentions. List two other explanations.
- ☐ Ask one neutral question about a small uncertainty, such as “Could you explain the plan?” Listen without repeating the question for reassurance.
- ☐ When there is no concrete sign of danger, postpone an unnecessary check for 15 minutes. Rate your anxiety before and after, then return to an ordinary task.
- ☐ Agree on one small shared plan with a dependable friend. Compare what you predicted with what the person actually did.

Choose an ordinary, low-stakes situation. Do not use these exercises with someone who is threatening, coercive, or abusive, or to dismiss concrete evidence of deception.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, record the song, the truth it reinforces, and one way to practice that truth today.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~People always try to hide what they are doing~~

NEW TRUTH:
Missing information is not proof of deception. I can ask clearly, judge actions fairly, and trust God with what I do not know.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Psalm 56:3

A short prayer

Lord, thank You that You are faithful. Help me notice trustworthy people, trust wisely, set healthy limits, and remember that I am safe in Your care. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #5 · TRUSTING OTHERS · KEEPING THINGS IN PERSPECTIVE

“Little things often have great significance”

✦ ✦ ✦

Does one small remark, mistake, delay, or change in someone’s expression take on great importance in your mind? Do you find yourself making a mountain out of a molehill? The information below can help you widen your attention, examine the evidence, and give everyday events a fair sense of proportion. God’s Word offers guidance for responding with patience, perspective, and peace.

Where it often comes from

When small details once preceded criticism, conflict, or disappointment, you may have learned to watch them closely. Repeated warnings, perfectionistic expectations, or stressful experiences can also teach you that little mistakes have major consequences. A habit that once seemed protective may continue even when today’s small event has little lasting importance.

How the belief can keep itself going

Selective attention draws you toward one troubling detail while the rest of the situation fades into the background. Magnification then makes that detail seem more serious, meaningful, or lasting than the evidence supports. For example, a friend’s brief reply may overshadow years of kindness and become “proof” that the friendship is failing. Replaying the detail can increase anxiety and lead to reactions that are larger than the original event warrants.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture encourages us to consider what is true and to widen our attention beyond a single upsetting detail. Patience allows time to listen before we react. We can address today’s actual problem without adding imagined consequences for tomorrow. Bringing anxiety to God can help us choose a response that fits the facts. Some small details do matter; the goal is to evaluate their importance rather than automatically magnify them.

> *“Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think on these things.” (Philippians 4:8)*

Also see

> “My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger,” (James 1:19)

> “A man’s insight gives him patience, and his virtue is to overlook an offense.” (Proverbs 19:11)

> “Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own.” (Matthew 6:34)

> “Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you.” (1 Peter 5:7)

Common self-statements

- That small comment must mean something serious.
- One mistake changes everything.

- If I ignore this detail, I will regret it.
- This little setback shows that everything is going wrong.
- I need to keep thinking about it until I know its full meaning.
- The fact that I noticed it means it must be important.

Common logical errors

- Selective attention: Focusing on one troubling detail while missing neutral or positive information.
- Magnification: Exaggerating the importance, severity, or likely consequences of a small event.
- Catastrophizing: Extending a minor setback into a prediction of disaster.
- Overgeneralization: Using one moment to judge an entire relationship, ability, or future.
- Emotional reasoning: Assuming that because an event feels significant, it must be significant.

Challenging questions

- What actually happened, described without adding a conclusion?
- Am I focusing on one detail and overlooking the rest of the picture?
- What evidence makes this important, and what evidence suggests it is minor?
- How important is this on a scale from 0 to 10 compared with a genuinely serious problem?
- Will this probably matter in a week, a month, or a year?
- What would a calm, fair observer say about this?
- What response fits the actual size of the problem?

Truth summary

Little things can matter, but they do not always have great significance. A single detail is only part of the picture. I can check the facts, consider the context, and respond in proportion to the actual problem. I can trust God with my concerns and give my attention to what is true and constructive.

A short prayer

Father, help me see the whole picture when one small detail fills my mind. Teach me to distinguish a minor concern from a serious problem. Give me patience to pause, wisdom to respond in proportion, and peace as I place my worries in Your care. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Wisdom
- Truth

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Communication

- Judgmental
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. These lyric videos display words on screen.

Voice of Truth
Casting Crowns

Reflect on testing a frightening interpretation against truth rather than letting fear give one detail its meaning.

Battle Belongs
Phil Wickham

Bring worries to God and reflect on seeing beyond the difficulty that currently fills your attention.

Turn Your Eyes
Sovereign Grace Music

Shift attention toward Christ and place a troubling detail within a larger perspective.

Look Up Child
Lauren Daigle

Practice looking beyond an upsetting moment and remembering God's care.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: this card targets selective attention (mental filtering) and magnification. It follows Identify → Challenge → Replace through reviewing context, scaling importance, generating balanced alternatives, and testing proportionate responses. These thinking habits occur across different difficulties and do not establish a personality disorder. The exercises are educational applications of CBT principles, not a validated treatment protocol for this exact sentence. Evaluate genuine warning signs in context; proportionate thinking does not mean dismissing actual harm.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "How can I keep small problems small, see the whole picture, and respond with God's wisdom today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Little things often have great significance"

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Little things often have great significance" I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Choose a question that helps you put a small event in perspective.

- ☐ What actually happened, described without adding a conclusion?
- ☐ Am I focusing on one detail and overlooking the rest of the picture?
- ☐ What evidence makes this important, and what evidence suggests it is minor?
- ☐ How important is this on a scale from 0 to 10 compared with a genuinely serious problem?
- ☐ Will this probably matter in a week, a month, or a year?
- ☐ What would a calm, fair observer say about this?
- ☐ What response fits the actual size of the problem?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ One small event does not tell the whole story.
- ☐ My attention can make a detail feel bigger than it is.
- ☐ I can consider the whole situation before deciding what it means.
- ☐ An unpleasant moment is not necessarily a major problem.
- ☐ I can handle a small problem with a small, practical response.
- ☐ God can help me respond with patience and perspective.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Philippians 4:8
  "Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think on these things."
- ☐ James 1:19
  "My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger,"
- ☐ Proverbs 19:11
  "A man's insight gives him patience, and his virtue is to overlook an offense."

- [ ] Matthew 6:34
  "Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own."
- [ ] 1 Peter 5:7
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Trust. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Read your Truth Card three times daily and memorize your chosen verse. Set a phone or watch reminder, or place a note where you will see it. Listen to one song daily and record the truth you want to practice.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Widen the picture: Record one minor upsetting event. Write the troubling detail, then add five relevant facts you initially overlooked. Rate its importance before and after.
- ☐ Use a fair scale: Place a small inconvenience on a 0–10 importance scale, with concrete examples of minor, moderate, and serious problems. Choose a response of similar size.
- ☐ Try a small response: For an ordinary, low-stakes issue, pause for ten minutes and use one brief practical action instead of prolonged analysis. Compare your prediction with the result.
- ☐ Check over time: Predict how much a minor event will matter tomorrow. Revisit it the next day and compare its actual consequences with your expectation.

Choose a minor everyday event, such as a brief reply, a small mistake, or a short delay. Do not postpone action on urgent safety, health, or financial concerns.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, record the song, the truth it reinforces, and one way to practice that truth today.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Little things often have great significance~~

NEW TRUTH:
One detail is not the whole picture. I can check its importance and give a small problem a proportionate response.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Philippians 4:8

A short prayer

Father, help me see the whole picture when one small detail fills my mind. Teach me to distinguish a minor concern from a serious problem. Give me patience to pause, wisdom to respond in proportion, and peace as I place my worries in Your care. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #6 · CONFIDENCE WITH PEOPLE · SAFER TO STAY AWAY

“Avoiding people and new challenges is safer than risking embarrassment.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you steer clear of social situations, new jobs, or new activities because you fear embarrassment or criticism? Do you feel safer staying on the sidelines? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward trying again, and to find the courage that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Repeated criticism, teasing, shaming, or being left out can teach a person that other people are a source of pain. A child who was often corrected harshly, compared with others, or humiliated may learn that staying quiet and out of view is the best way to stay safe. Over time, avoiding feels like wisdom rather than fear.

How the belief can keep itself going

Avoiding gives quick relief, and relief makes avoiding feel like the right choice. But the person never learns that most situations are survivable or that people are often kinder than expected. Skills stay unpracticed, opportunities pass, and loneliness grows, which can seem to confirm the original fear. Small steps, taken gradually, let us gather new evidence.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest about fear and does not shame us for it. The Lord says over and over, “Do not fear,” and ties that command to His presence and help. The fear of other people can become a snare, but trusting the Lord sets us securely. These passages do not call us to be reckless. They remind us that we do not take each step alone.

> *“The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high.” (Proverbs 29:25)*

Also see

> “Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness.” (Isaiah 41:10)

> “For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control.” (2 Timothy 1:7)

> “When I am afraid, I put my trust in You.” (Psalm 56:3)

> “Have I not commanded you to be strong and courageous? Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged, for the LORD your God is with you wherever you go.” (Joshua 1:9)

Common self-statements

- It is safer to stay home than to risk looking foolish.
- I will pass on that job or event; I would only embarrass myself.
- If I never try, I can never fail in front of anyone.
- I will wait until I feel confident before I join in.
- I would rather be alone than be judged.

• Why take the chance when I already know how it will go?

Common logical errors

• Fortune telling: Predicting that I will embarrass myself before I have tried.

• Catastrophizing: Treating a possible awkward moment as a disaster I could not survive.

• Emotional reasoning: Taking the feeling of dread as proof that the situation is dangerous.

• All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that if I cannot do it perfectly, I should not do it at all.

• Discounting the positive: Ignoring times when I took a risk and it turned out fine.

• Overestimating the cost: Believing others will notice and remember my mistakes far more than they do.

Challenging questions

• What exactly am I afraid will happen, and how likely is it?

• If it did happen, how bad would it really be, and could I cope with it?

• What is the cost of staying away, in friendships, work, and joy?

• Has avoiding ever made the fear smaller in the long run, or larger?

• Can I recall a time I took a small risk and it went better than I expected?

• What is one very small step I could take this week, with God's help?

• If a friend described this fear, what would I encourage them to do?

Truth summary

Feeling afraid is not the same as being in danger. Avoiding gives short-term relief but keeps the fear alive and shrinks my life. I can take small, manageable steps and learn from what actually happens. Embarrassment is uncomfortable, but I can survive it, and God is with me in every step.

A short prayer

Lord, You know how heavy this fear feels. Be my security when I want to hide. Give me courage for one small step today, and remind me that I am never alone. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

• Fear

• Trust

• Strength

• Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

• Anxiety, Worry, Fear

• Self-Esteem, Low

• Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Trust in God
Elevation Worship feat. Chris Brown

Reflect on trusting God when stepping out feels risky.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember God's goodness in each small step you take.

No Longer Slaves
Jonathan David & Melissa Helser

Practice replacing fear with the confidence that you belong to God.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Let your identity rest in who God says you are.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call avoidant personality disorder. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Avoiding feared situations is the most common way anxiety is maintained; gradual exposure is a central treatment for social anxiety and for avoidant patterns, and it can occur with depression, trauma, or other conditions. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Psychological difficulties have multiple contributing factors. Gradual exposure should be paced to the person; anyone with severe anxiety, depression, or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What is one small step I can take today instead of avoiding?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Avoiding people and new challenges is safer than risking embarrassment."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Avoiding people and new challenges is safer than risking embarrassment." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you feel like staying away.

- ☐ What exactly am I afraid will happen, and how likely is it?
- ☐ If it did happen, how bad would it really be, and could I cope with it?
- ☐ What is the cost of staying away, in friendships, work, and joy?
- ☐ Has avoiding ever made the fear smaller in the long run, or larger?
- ☐ Can I recall a time I took a small risk and it went better than I expected?
- ☐ What is one very small step I could take this week, with God's help?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Feeling afraid is not the same as being in danger.
- ☐ I can take small steps and learn from what really happens.
- ☐ Avoiding helps for a moment, but it keeps the fear going.
- ☐ I can survive embarrassment, and I can grow from it.
- ☐ I do not have to feel confident first; I can act while still nervous.
- ☐ God is with me, so I do not face each step alone.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Proverbs 29:25
  "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high."
- ☐ Isaiah 41:10
  "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness."
- ☐ 2 Timothy 1:7
  "For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control."

- [ ] Psalm 56:3
  "When I am afraid, I put my trust in You."
- [ ] Joshua 1:9
  "Have I not commanded you to be strong and courageous? Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged, for the LORD your God is with you wherever you go."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Fear. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Choose one small, low-risk social step this week, such as greeting a neighbor or sending a short message. Predict what will happen, then record what did.
- ☐ Say yes to one small invitation or activity you would normally decline. Stay for a set short time, then notice how it went.
- ☐ Ask a question or share a short opinion in a group, then rate how bad it actually was from 0 to 10.
- ☐ Try one new activity alone in public, such as a class, a library visit, or a walk in a busy place. Note what you feared and what happened.
- ☐ Make a “fear ladder” of five situations from easiest to hardest and do the easiest one. Repeat it until it feels easier.
- ☐ Write an honest prayer about what scares you, then choose one small step to take today.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about courage, trust, and taking small steps with God.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Avoiding people and new challenges is safer than risking embarrassment.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Fear is not danger. I can take small steps, learn from what happens, and trust that God is with me.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Proverbs 29:25

A short prayer

Lord, thank You that You are with me. Give me courage for small steps, patience with myself, and trust that I am safe in Your care. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #7 · CONFIDENCE WITH PEOPLE · LESS THAN OTHERS

"I am inadequate and less than other people."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you often feel that you fall short and that everyone else is more capable, interesting, or worthy than you are? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward seeing yourself as God sees you, and to find the confidence that comes from knowing His word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Harsh criticism, constant comparison with a sibling or classmate, being rejected, or growing up without encouragement can plant the idea that we are not enough. A child cannot easily separate "what happened to me" from "who I am," so the feeling can settle in as a belief about identity.

How the belief can keep itself going

Comparing ourselves with others' best moments makes us look smaller. We may stay quiet to avoid being noticed, then read our silence as proof that we have little to offer. We discount compliments and magnify mistakes. Looking for evidence that does not fit the belief can begin to loosen it.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture teaches that our worth does not come from comparison or performance. God made each person with care, calls us His workmanship, and makes us complete in Christ. Where we feel weak, His strength is not blocked but displayed. These passages speak about our value in God's eyes; they do not say we have no growing to do.

> *"I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well." (Psalm 139:14)*

Also see

> "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life." (Ephesians 2:10)

> "And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority." (Colossians 2:10)

> "Not that we are competent in ourselves to claim that anything comes from us, but our competence comes from God." (2 Corinthians 3:5)

> "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me." (2 Corinthians 12:9)

Common self-statements

- Everyone else seems to have it together except me.
- I am not as smart, interesting, or capable as other people.
- I do not belong here.
- Other people are simply better than I am.
- I will never measure up.
- If they only knew how ordinary I am, they would lose interest.

Common logical errors

- Social comparison: Measuring my inner struggles against other people's outward appearance.
- Global labeling: Turning "I made a mistake" into "I am inadequate."
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing compliments and successes as luck or politeness.
- Mental filter: Noticing my flaws while overlooking my strengths.
- Emotional reasoning: Taking the feeling of being "less than" as proof that I am.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I must be outstanding or I am worthless.

Challenging questions

- Where did I first learn that I was not enough, and who said it?
- What would I say to a friend who described themselves this way?
- What are three things I do well or that others have appreciated in me?
- Am I comparing my whole self to someone else's highlight?
- What does God say about my value, and does it depend on my performance?
- Is it fair to judge my whole worth by one weakness or one failure?
- What is one strength I could use this week?

Truth summary

I am not less than others. My worth does not rise and fall with comparison; it comes from God, who made me with care and loves me. I have strengths and weaknesses like everyone, and my weaknesses do not cancel my value. In Christ I am complete, and I can grow without being ashamed of where I am now.

A short prayer

Father, thank You for making me on purpose. When I feel less than, remind me that my worth rests in You. Help me see the gifts You have given me and receive Your love today. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, by God
- Guilt and Shame
- Strength

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Let your identity rest in who God says you are.

Known
Tauren Wells

Consider being fully known and fully loved.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Practice bringing yourself to God just as you are.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember God's goodness toward you, not your performance.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call avoidant personality disorder. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. A persistent sense of being less than others is common in depression, social anxiety, and low self-esteem, and often develops from early criticism or comparison. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Psychological difficulties have multiple contributing factors. Gradual exposure should be paced to the person; anyone with severe anxiety, depression, or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What does God say about me today, and what is one thing I can do well?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am inadequate and less than other people."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I am inadequate and less than other people." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you feel less than others.

- ☐ Where did I first learn that I was not enough, and who said it?
- ☐ What would I say to a friend who described themselves this way?
- ☐ What are three things I do well or that others have appreciated in me?
- ☐ Am I comparing my whole self to someone else's highlight?
- ☐ What does God say about my value, and does it depend on my performance?
- ☐ Is it fair to judge my whole worth by one weakness or one failure?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I am not less than others; my worth comes from God.
- ☐ I have both strengths and weaknesses, like everyone.
- ☐ One mistake does not make me inadequate.
- ☐ Comparison gives me a distorted picture.
- ☐ I am complete in Christ and can grow without shame.
- ☐ I can receive a compliment and say thank you.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ Ephesians 2:10
  "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life."
- ☐ Colossians 2:10
  "And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 3:5
  "Not that we are competent in ourselves to claim that anything comes from us, but our competence comes from God."

☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Self-Esteem, Low. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Write down three strengths and one kind thing someone has said about you. Read them each morning this week.
- ☐ Each time you compare yourself with someone, write one thing you do well that they may not.
- ☐ Accept one compliment this week by simply saying “Thank you,” without explaining it away.
- ☐ Ask a trusted friend what they appreciate about you. Compare their answer with your prediction.
- ☐ Do one task you do well and notice how you feel afterward.
- ☐ Write a short prayer thanking God for one way He made you.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about identity and worth in God's eyes.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I am inadequate and less than other people.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I am not less than others. I am made by God, loved by Him, and complete in Christ.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Psalm 139:14

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for making me and for loving me. Help me see myself as You see me and to accept Your love today. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #8 · CONFIDENCE WITH PEOPLE · POOR SOCIAL SELF-IMAGE

“I am awkward and unlikable, and I have little to offer.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Are you hard on yourself about your personality and social skills? Do you assume that others find you dull, awkward, or unappealing? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward a kinder, truer view of yourself, and to find the encouragement that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Being teased, ignored, or told “you’re too quiet” or “you’re too much” can teach a person to distrust their own personality. Shyness or a few awkward moments can be remembered vividly and turned into a verdict. Growing up without chances to practice friendships can also leave a person unsure of themselves.

How the belief can keep itself going

When we expect to be disliked, we watch ourselves closely, which makes conversation harder. We read neutral faces as bored or unimpressed and replay every awkward moment afterward. We may then avoid people, which leaves less practice and fewer good experiences. Shifting attention outward, to the other person, often helps.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture describes the body of Christ as many different parts, each needed, including those that seem weaker. God gives every person gifts to serve others, and He is not impressed by outward appearance. These passages speak to our value and our contribution; they do not say that social skills cannot be learned and strengthened.

> *“On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable.” (1 Corinthians 12:22)*

Also see

> “As good stewards of the manifold grace of God, each of you should use whatever gift he has received to serve one another.” (1 Peter 4:10)

> “Just as each of us has one body with many members, and not all members have the same function.” (Romans 12:4)

> “But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’” (1 Samuel 16:7)

> “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb.” (Psalm 139:13)

Common self-statements

- I never know what to say.
- I am boring.
- People are just being polite when they talk to me.
- There is something wrong with my personality.
- I have nothing interesting to add.
- I am not the kind of person people want to be around.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming others find me dull without asking or checking.
- Spotlight effect: Believing others notice and remember my awkward moments far more than they do.
- Mental filter: Replaying one stumble and forgetting the conversations that went fine.
- Global labeling: Turning “I felt awkward” into “I am awkward.”
- Discounting the positive: Explaining away friendliness as mere politeness.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unlikable and concluding that I must be.

Challenging questions

- What evidence do I have that people dislike me, and what evidence goes the other way?
- Has anyone ever enjoyed my company, thanked me, or asked to see me again?
- How would I judge someone else who stumbled in a conversation?
- What would I tell a friend who described their personality this way?
- Do I notice others’ awkward moments as much as I notice my own?
- What gift or quality do I bring that I tend to overlook?
- What social skill could I practice a little at a time?

Truth summary

I am not defined by my shyness or my awkward moments. Everyone stumbles in conversation, and most people are focused on themselves. Social skills can be learned and strengthened with practice. God made me with a unique personality and gifts, and I have something real to offer.

A short prayer

Lord, You made me and You see my heart. Quiet the voice that says I am not enough. Help me move toward people with kindness, and use the gifts You have given me. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Friendship
- Church
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Communication
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Let your identity rest in who God says you are.

Known
Tauren Wells

Consider being fully known and loved.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Practice coming as you are.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember God's goodness while you practice small steps.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call avoidant personality disorder. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. A harsh view of one's social skills often reflects anxious self-monitoring rather than actual skill deficits; social skills can be practiced and strengthened, and the pattern can occur with social anxiety and depression. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Psychological difficulties have multiple contributing factors. Gradual exposure should be paced to the person; anyone with severe anxiety, depression, or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What is one kind thing I can offer someone today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am awkward and unlikable, and I have little to offer."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I am awkward and unlikable, and I have little to offer." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you feel awkward or unlikable.

- ☐ What evidence do I have that people dislike me, and what evidence goes the other way?
- ☐ Has anyone ever enjoyed my company, thanked me, or asked to see me again?
- ☐ How would I judge someone else who stumbled in a conversation?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend who described their personality this way?
- ☐ Do I notice others' awkward moments as much as I notice my own?
- ☐ What gift or quality do I bring that I tend to overlook?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ One awkward moment does not describe my personality.
- ☐ Most people are focused on themselves, not on my slips.
- ☐ I can learn and practice social skills.
- ☐ I have gifts and qualities worth sharing.
- ☐ Someone enjoying my company is real, not just politeness.
- ☐ God made me on purpose, and I have something to offer.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."
- ☐ 1 Peter 4:10
  "As good stewards of the manifold grace of God, each of you should use whatever gift he has received to serve one another."
- ☐ Romans 12:4
  "Just as each of us has one body with many members, and not all members have the same function."
- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7

"But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"

☐ Psalm 139:13
"For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Self-Esteem, Low. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Start one short, friendly conversation this week with a clerk, neighbor, or coworker. Record what you predicted and what happened.
- ☐ Ask someone a question about themselves and listen for two minutes. Notice how it feels to focus outward.
- ☐ Give one sincere compliment today and notice the response.
- ☐ Keep a list of good interactions this week, even small ones. Review it at the end.
- ☐ Join one small group or class and attend twice before deciding how it went.
- ☐ Write a prayer thanking God for one quality He gave you.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about identity and the gifts God has given me.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I am awkward and unlikable, and I have little to offer.~~

NEW TRUTH:
One awkward moment is not my personality. God made me with gifts, and I have something to offer.

MY SCRIPTURE:
1 Corinthians 12:22

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for making me as I am. Help me move toward people with kindness and trust that I have something to give. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #9 · CONFIDENCE WITH PEOPLE · SAFE ONLY IF LIKED

"I must be sure people will like me before I let them know me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you wait until you are sure people will like you before you join in, open up, or let anyone see who you really are? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward letting others know you, and to find the freedom that comes from knowing God's word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

A person who was loved only when they performed well, or who was hurt after being open, may learn that acceptance must be earned first. Sharing something personal and being laughed at, or being betrayed, can lead to a rule: "Do not show myself until I know it is safe."

How the belief can keep itself going

Certainty about how others will respond is almost never possible, so the waiting never ends. Others may read our caution as coldness, and relationships stay on the surface. Closeness requires some risk, and without it we do not learn that we can be known and still accepted. Taking small, graded steps can help.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture tells us that God knows us completely and loves us anyway. Because He has accepted us in Christ, we are freed from the need to win everyone's approval. Perfect love casts out fear, and God invites us to accept one another as Christ accepted us. These passages do not say every person will respond kindly, only that our standing before God is secure.

> *"Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you, in order to bring glory to God." (Romans 15:7)*

Also see

> "O LORD, You have searched me and known me." (Psalm 139:1)

> "There is no fear in love, but perfect love drives out fear, because fear involves punishment. The one who fears has not been perfected in love." (1 John 4:18)

> "Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ." (Galatians 1:10)

> "A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother." (Proverbs 18:24)

Common self-statements

- I will join in when I am sure they like me.
- I should not open up until I know it is safe.
- If I show who I am, they will leave.
- I have to be liked first.
- I cannot risk it without a guarantee.

- It is better to keep my distance than to be rejected.

Common logical errors

- Demanding certainty: Requiring a guarantee that is never available.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that people will reject the real me.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either fully accept me or completely reject me.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know what others think of me without checking.
- Emotional reasoning: Taking the feeling of risk as proof of danger.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing times when someone accepted me.

Challenging questions

- Is it possible to be completely sure how someone will respond to me?
- What would I miss if I wait until I am certain?
- Has anyone ever liked me after getting to know me?
- What is the smallest, safest piece of myself I could share?
- Does my worth depend on whether this person likes me?
- How does God's knowledge of me, and His love, change my need for guarantees?
- What would a safe, trustworthy friend look like, and how would I know?

Truth summary

No one can be certain about how others will respond, and waiting for certainty keeps me from friendship. I can share a little at a time and see how people treat what I share. Not everyone will respond well, and that does not mean something is wrong with me. God already knows me and accepts me in Christ, so I can take small risks.

A short prayer

Father, You know me completely and love me still. When I want a guarantee before I connect, help me remember that Your acceptance is secure. Give me courage for a small, honest step today. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Love, by God
- Fear
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love
- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Known
Tauren Wells

Consider being fully known and loved.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Practice coming as you are.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Let your identity rest in who God says you are.

Trust in God
Elevation Worship feat. Chris Brown

Reflect on trusting God while taking small steps toward people.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call avoidant personality disorder. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Requiring certainty of acceptance before engaging is a common safety behavior in social anxiety; it prevents the corrective experience of being known and accepted, and graded self-disclosure is a typical treatment step. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Psychological difficulties have multiple contributing factors. Gradual exposure should be paced to the person; anyone with severe anxiety, depression, or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What small piece of myself can I share with a safe person today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must be sure people will like me before I let them know me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I must be sure people will like me before I let them know me." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you want a guarantee of being liked.

- ☐ Is it possible to be completely sure how someone will respond to me?
- ☐ What would I miss if I wait until I am certain?
- ☐ Has anyone ever liked me after getting to know me?
- ☐ What is the smallest, safest piece of myself I could share?
- ☐ Does my worth depend on whether this person likes me?
- ☐ How does God's knowledge of me, and His love, change my need for guarantees?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Certainty is not available, and waiting keeps me stuck.
- ☐ I can share a little at a time and see how people respond.
- ☐ My worth does not depend on one person's opinion.
- ☐ Not everyone will respond well, and that is not a verdict on me.
- ☐ God already knows me and accepts me in Christ.
- ☐ I can take a small risk with a safe person.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Romans 15:7
  "Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you, in order to bring glory to God."
- ☐ Psalm 139:1
  "O LORD, You have searched me and known me."
- ☐ 1 John 4:18
  "There is no fear in love, but perfect love drives out fear, because fear involves punishment. The one who fears has not been perfected in love."
- ☐ Galatians 1:10

“Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ.”

- [ ] Proverbs 18:24
“A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Friendship. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Share one small personal detail, such as a hobby or opinion, with a safe person this week. Predict their reaction, then record it.
- ☐ Respond to one invitation without first checking how everyone feels about you.
- ☐ Ask a friend for honest feedback on how they see you, then compare it with what you feared.
- ☐ Notice when you are waiting for a guarantee. Write the thought and take one small step anyway.
- ☐ Start or continue one conversation that goes a little beyond small talk.
- ☐ Write a prayer about wanting to be known, and take one small step toward a safe person.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being known and loved.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I must be sure people will like me before I let them know me.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I do not need a guarantee. I can share a little at a time, and God already knows and accepts me.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Romans 15:7

A short prayer

Lord, thank You that You know me and love me. Help me share a little of myself with safe people and trust You with the results. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #10 · CONFIDENCE WITH PEOPLE · FEAR OF SHAME

“Ridicule or criticism would prove I am worthless, and I could not bear it.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you dread being laughed at, criticized, or shamed, feeling that it would prove you are worthless and be more than you could bear? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward seeing that your worth is not decided by what others say, and to find the peace that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

A person who was shamed in front of others, ridiculed at home or school, or humiliated for mistakes may come to dread it above almost anything. Early shaming can leave a lasting sense that exposure equals disgrace, so even mild criticism can feel like a blow to the whole self.

How the belief can keep itself going

When one criticism feels like proof of worthlessness, we stay away from anything that might invite it. Even in close relationships we hold back to avoid being seen in a weak moment. Because we never test the belief, we never find out that criticism is survivable and that it speaks about a behavior, not our whole worth. Learning to separate the two can be freeing.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture promises that those who trust in Christ will not be put to shame. Our standing before God does not depend on what others say about us, and Jesus Himself endured scorn and shame for us. There is no condemnation for those in Christ. These passages do not say people will never criticize us, but that their words do not define us.

> *“It is just as the Scripture says: ‘Anyone who believes in Him will never be put to shame.’” (Romans 10:11)*

Also see

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.” (Romans 8:1)

> “Do not be afraid, for you will not be put to shame; do not be intimidated, for you will not be humiliated. For you will forget the shame of your youth and will remember no more the reproach of your widowhood.” (Isaiah 54:4)

> “Let us fix our eyes on Jesus, the author and perfecter of our faith, who for the joy set before Him endured the cross, scorning its shame, and sat down at the right hand of the throne of God.” (Hebrews 12:2)

> “Those who look to Him are radiant with joy; their faces shall never be ashamed.” (Psalm 34:5)

Common self-statements

- If they laugh at me, I will be crushed.
- One criticism proves what I have always feared about myself.
- I could not stand being humiliated.
- Being embarrassed would be the worst thing.
- If I fail in front of people, I will never recover.

- Criticism means I am worthless.

Common logical errors

- Catastrophizing: Treating embarrassment as unbearable rather than uncomfortable.
- Global labeling: Turning one criticism into "I am worthless."
- Emotional reasoning: Taking the sting of criticism as proof that I am bad.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either approved of or humiliated.
- Fortune telling: Predicting ridicule before it happens.
- Personalization: Assuming every critical remark is about my whole self.

Challenging questions

- When someone criticized me before, did I actually survive it?
- Does one person's criticism or laughter really determine my worth?
- Is it possible to feel embarrassed and still be a person of value?
- What is the difference between "I made a mistake" and "I am worthless"?
- How would I view someone else who was criticized in the same way?
- What does God say about shame, and about my standing before Him?
- How long would an embarrassing moment really last, and what would I do afterward?

Truth summary

Criticism can hurt, but it does not determine my worth. Embarrassment is painful, and I can bear it; it passes. My value is set by God, who has declared there is no condemnation for those in Christ. I can listen to useful feedback, let go of cruel words, and keep my place in His love.

A short prayer

Lord, You bore shame for me. When I fear ridicule, remind me that I am Yours and that no one's words can change Your love. Give me strength to face uncomfortable moments and peace afterward. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Guilt and Shame
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Fear
- Love, by God

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Anxiety, Worry, Fear
- Forgive, Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Let your identity rest in who God says you are.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Practice bringing your shame to God.

Known
Tauren Wells

Consider being fully known and still loved.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember God's goodness when others' words sting.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call avoidant personality disorder. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Intense fear of shame and humiliation, with the belief that criticism confirms worthlessness, is common in social anxiety and depression and often traces to early shaming experiences; separating behavior from worth is a core cognitive step. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Psychological difficulties have multiple contributing factors. Gradual exposure should be paced to the person; anyone with severe anxiety, depression, or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What does God say about me, no matter what anyone else says?"

My Plan for Replacing "Ridicule or criticism would prove I am worthless, and I could not bear it."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Ridicule or criticism would prove I am worthless, and I could not bear it." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you fear being ridiculed.

- ☐ When someone criticized me before, did I actually survive it?
- ☐ Does one person's criticism or laughter really determine my worth?
- ☐ Is it possible to feel embarrassed and still be a person of value?
- ☐ What is the difference between "I made a mistake" and "I am worthless"?
- ☐ How would I view someone else who was criticized in the same way?
- ☐ What does God say about shame, and about my standing before Him?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Criticism can hurt, but it does not determine my worth.
- ☐ Embarrassment is uncomfortable, and I can bear it.
- ☐ A mistake is not the same as being worthless.
- ☐ There is no condemnation for those in Christ.
- ☐ I can learn from fair feedback and let go of cruel words.
- ☐ My value comes from God, not from anyone's approval.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Romans 10:11
  "It is just as the Scripture says: 'Anyone who believes in Him will never be put to shame.'"
- ☐ Romans 8:1
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Isaiah 54:4
  "Do not be afraid, for you will not be put to shame; do not be intimidated, for you will not be humiliated. For you will forget the shame of your youth and will remember no more the reproach of your widowhood."

- [ ] Hebrews 12:2
  "Let us fix our eyes on Jesus, the author and perfecter of our faith, who for the joy set before Him endured the cross, scorning its shame, and sat down at the right hand of the throne of God."
- [ ] Psalm 34:5
  "Those who look to Him are radiant with joy; their faces shall never be ashamed."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Guilt and Shame. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Recall one time you were embarrassed or criticized. Write how long it lasted, how you coped, and what happened afterward.
- ☐ Make one small, harmless mistake on purpose, such as a minor mispronunciation, and notice how others respond.
- ☐ When you receive criticism this week, write what was said, what part is useful, and what part is not about your worth.
- ☐ Ask a trusted person for one piece of honest feedback and practice listening without defending.
- ☐ Share a small imperfect effort, such as a draft or a new skill, with someone safe.
- ☐ Write a prayer giving your fear of shame to God, and read Romans 10:11 aloud.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about shame, worth, and God's acceptance.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Ridicule or criticism would prove I am worthless, and I could not bear it.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Criticism does not determine my worth. I can bear embarrassment, and I belong to God.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Romans 10:11

A short prayer

Lord, thank You that I will not be put to shame in You. Help me face hard moments with courage and rest in Your love. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

“Getting close to people will cost me my freedom.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you find yourself pulling away when someone tries to get close? Do you worry that letting people in will mean losing your independence or being controlled? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward seeing that closeness with safe people does not have to cost you your freedom, and to find the peace that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

A person who grew up with controlling, intrusive, or unpredictable caregivers may learn that being close means being managed, criticized, or swallowed up. Others learned that needs were a burden and that self-reliance was the safe way to live. Distance then feels like freedom, even when it has quietly become the walls of a small life.

How the belief can keep itself going

Keeping people at arm’s length does protect us from being controlled, so it seems to work. But the same distance blocks the experience of being close to someone who respects us, so the belief never gets tested. We also tend to picture closeness at its worst. Gathering evidence from safe, healthy relationships can start to loosen it.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not describe freedom as the absence of people. Christ sets us free, and that freedom is meant to be lived out in love for others. God places the lonely in families. Real love does not seize control; it serves. These passages teach that closeness and freedom were never meant to be enemies.

> *“For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love.” (Galatians 5:13)*

Also see

> “It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not be encumbered once more by a yoke of slavery.” (Galatians 5:1)

> “So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed.” (John 8:36)

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land.” (Psalm 68:6)

> “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.” (Proverbs 27:17)

Common self-statements

- If I let someone in, they will take over my life.
- I need my space, and people always want more of me.
- Being close means giving up who I am.
- I stay free by not getting involved.
- Commitments are cages.
- It is easier to keep everyone at a distance.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either completely free and alone or completely controlled and close.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that anyone close to me will take over.
- Overgeneralizing: Assuming everyone will treat me the way a controlling person once did.
- Emotional reasoning: Taking the feeling of being crowded as proof that I am in danger.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing times when someone was close and still respected my space.
- Mislabeling: Calling every kind of closeness "control."

Challenging questions

- Who, in my past, made closeness feel like a loss of freedom, and is everyone like that person?
- Can I think of a person who respected my space and my choices?
- What has staying distant cost me, and what has it protected?
- Can closeness have boundaries, so that I can say yes or no and still be close?
- What does Scripture say real freedom is for?
- Could a small, chosen amount of closeness feel different from being controlled?
- What is one safe person with whom I could practice saying what I need?

Truth summary

Closeness and freedom are not opposites. Healthy relationships have room for boundaries, differences, and choices. I can say no and still be loved. Christ gives me true freedom, and He invites me to use it to love and be loved. I can choose how close to get, one safe step at a time.

A short prayer

Lord, You know why I guard my freedom so tightly. Heal the places where closeness once hurt. Show me safe people, teach me healthy boundaries, and help me use the freedom You gave me to love and be loved. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love
- Communication
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Rest in being welcomed as you are, with no pressure to perform.

Known
Tauren Wells

Reflect on being fully known and still loved.

No Longer Slaves
Jonathan David & Melissa Helser

Remember that in Christ you are no longer a slave to fear.

Trust in God
Elevation Worship feat. Chris Brown

Practice trusting God as you let others closer, step by step.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Detachment is sometimes a learned response to intrusive or controlling relationships; distinguishing a person's real boundary needs from fear-based avoidance helps set the pace. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What is one small, safe connection I can choose today, on my own terms?"

My Plan for Replacing "Getting close to people will cost me my freedom."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Getting close to people will cost me my freedom." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when closeness starts to feel like a loss of freedom.

- ☐ Who, in my past, made closeness feel like a loss of freedom, and is everyone like that person?
- ☐ Can I think of a person who respected my space and my choices?
- ☐ What has staying distant cost me, and what has it protected?
- ☐ Can closeness have boundaries, so that I can say yes or no and still be close?
- ☐ What does Scripture say real freedom is for?
- ☐ Could a small, chosen amount of closeness feel different from being controlled?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Closeness and freedom can live together.
- ☐ I can set boundaries and still be close.
- ☐ I can say no and still be loved.
- ☐ Not every person will control me the way someone once did.
- ☐ Christ gives me freedom to love and be loved.
- ☐ I choose how close to get, one step at a time.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Galatians 5:13
  "For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love."
- ☐ Galatians 5:1
  "It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not be encumbered once more by a yoke of slavery."
- ☐ John 8:36
  "So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed."
- ☐ Psalm 68:6

“God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land.”

☐ Proverbs 27:17
“As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Loneliness. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Choose one safe person and spend a short, planned time together, such as a coffee or a walk. Decide in advance how long you will stay.
- ☐ Practice one respectful “no” or “not right now” with someone safe, and notice whether the relationship survives.
- ☐ Tell a trusted person one small thing you need, such as quiet time after a gathering.
- ☐ List three ways a close relationship could add to your freedom, such as help, company, and encouragement.
- ☐ Notice one moment this week when someone respected your space, and write down what happened.
- ☐ Write a prayer about what you fear losing, and read Galatians 5:13 aloud.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about freedom, closeness, and being welcomed by God.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Getting close to people will cost me my freedom.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Closeness and freedom can go together. I can set boundaries, say no, and still be loved.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Galatians 5:13

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for the freedom You gave me. Help me to use it to love, to set healthy boundaries, and to let safe people in. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

“I don’t need anyone. I am better off alone.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you feel that you are better off on your own and that you don’t really need anyone? Have you learned to rely only on yourself? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward seeing that God made us for relationship, and to find the comfort that comes from knowing His word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

A child whose needs went unmet, or who learned that people were unreliable, can decide to need no one. Being self-sufficient then becomes a source of pride and safety. Some people also find quiet and solitude genuinely restful, and the belief grows from a real preference stretched into a rule about everyone.

How the belief can keep itself going

Needing no one can feel strong, and it protects from disappointment. But it also means the person never receives what only others can give, such as comfort, correction, laughter, and help. Without those experiences, there is nothing to challenge the belief, and solitude can slowly become isolation.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says plainly that it is not good for us to be alone. God designed us for one another, like parts of one body, and no part can truthfully say to another, “I do not need you.” Quiet time with God is good and Jesus often withdrew to pray, but He did not live cut off from people. These passages teach that need is part of how we were made, not a weakness.

> *“The LORD God also said, ‘It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.’” (Genesis 2:18)*

Also see

> “The eye cannot say to the hand, ‘I do not need you.’ Nor can the head say to the feet, ‘I do not need you.’” (1 Corinthians 12:21)

> “So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another.” (Romans 12:5)

> “He who isolates himself pursues selfish desires; he rebels against all sound judgment.” (Proverbs 18:1)

> “A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity.” (Proverbs 17:17)

Common self-statements

- I do not need anyone.
- I am happier on my own.
- People just complicate things.
- I have always been a loner, and that is fine.
- I can handle everything myself.
- Other people are not worth the trouble.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning “I enjoy quiet” into “nobody is necessary.”
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing life as either independent or dependent, with nothing in between.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring times when someone’s help, company, or kindness made things better.
- Mislabeling: Calling a fear of being hurt “independence.”
- Selective attention: Counting the problems people cause and overlooking what they give.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling calm when alone and concluding that it is all I need.

Challenging questions

- What is the difference between enjoying solitude and believing I need no one?
- When was the last time I truly needed help, and what happened?
- What did I learn early in life about whether people could be counted on?
- What might I be missing by never letting anyone in?
- What does God say about the way He made us?
- Is it possible that being “better off alone” is a belief I learned, not a fact?
- If a friend told me they needed no one, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

Enjoying quiet time is healthy, but needing no one is not how God made me. He created us for one another, and receiving help, comfort, and friendship is part of being human. I can value solitude and still choose connection. Needing others is not weakness; it is design.

A short prayer

Lord, You made me for connection, even when I have learned to live without it. Soften the places where I decided to need no one. Bring safe people into my life, and help me to receive what You want to give through them. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Church
- Help

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Known
Tauren Wells

Reflect on the comfort of being fully known and loved.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Let yourself be welcomed, even in your need.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember that God's goodness often reaches us through people.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Rest in who God says you are, a person made for love.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. A preference for solitude is not itself a problem; the concern is a rigid conviction that closeness has no value, especially when it narrows life or costs the person support. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Who could I reach out to, or receive from, today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I don't need anyone. I am better off alone."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I don't need anyone. I am better off alone." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "I don't need anyone."

- ☐ What is the difference between enjoying solitude and believing I need no one?
- ☐ When was the last time I truly needed help, and what happened?
- ☐ What did I learn early in life about whether people could be counted on?
- ☐ What might I be missing by never letting anyone in?
- ☐ What does God say about the way He made us?
- ☐ Is it possible that being "better off alone" is a belief I learned, not a fact?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Enjoying solitude is good, but I was made for connection.
- ☐ Needing others is not weakness; it is how God designed me.
- ☐ I can value quiet and still choose people.
- ☐ Help and company can add to my life.
- ☐ I do not have to do everything alone.
- ☐ God places people in my life as a gift.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Genesis 2:18
  "The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'"
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:21
  "The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I do not need you.' Nor can the head say to the feet, 'I do not need you.'"
- ☐ Romans 12:5
  "So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another."
- ☐ Proverbs 18:1
  "He who isolates himself pursues selfish desires; he rebels against all sound judgment."

☐ Proverbs 17:17
“A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Loneliness. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ List three times someone helped you, and note how it felt.
- ☐ Ask one safe person for a small favor or piece of advice, and record what happened.
- ☐ Accept an invitation you would usually decline, and stay for a set short time.
- ☐ Send a short message to someone you have not spoken to in a while.
- ☐ Spend a few minutes noticing what you enjoy about being with a particular person.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to show you who He has placed in your life.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being known, welcomed, and made for connection.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I don't need anyone. I am better off alone.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I was made for connection. Needing others is not weakness; it is how God designed me.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Genesis 2:18

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for making me for relationship. Help me to value quiet without shutting people out, and to receive the help and friendship You provide. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #13 · CLOSENESS AND CONNECTION · DEPENDING CAUSES TROUBLE

“Depending on anyone only leads to trouble.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you hesitate to count on anyone because you expect to be let down? Do you feel that depending on others only leads to trouble? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward trusting dependable people again, and to find the security that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

When people who should have been dependable were absent, unpredictable, or let us down, we learn that depending on others ends in disappointment. A child who had to take care of herself or himself too early can decide that needing anyone is dangerous. Self-reliance then feels like wisdom.

How the belief can keep itself going

If we never depend on anyone, no one has the chance to prove reliable. Every close call is remembered, and every kept promise goes unnoticed. We also take on everything alone, which can lead to exhaustion and loneliness, and that seems to confirm that people are not worth the trouble.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture teaches that two are better than one, and that a companion can lift us up when we fall. Our first dependence is on God, who is faithful when people are not, and He often helps us through the people He sends. We are also told to carry one another’s burdens. These passages do not say every person is reliable, but they show that wise, careful dependence is part of God’s design.

> *“Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!” (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10)*

Also see

> “And though one may be overpowered, two can resist. Moreover, a cord of three strands is not quickly broken.” (Ecclesiastes 4:12)

> “A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother.” (Proverbs 18:24)

> “Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge.” (Psalm 62:8)

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.” (Galatians 6:2)

Common self-statements

- If I rely on someone, they will let me down.
- It is safer to do everything myself.
- Needing people just creates problems.
- I do not ask for help.
- People are only reliable until they are not.

- I would rather struggle alone than owe anyone.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Concluding that everyone is undependable because some people were.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must depend on nobody or depend on everybody.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that anyone I rely on will fail me.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking times when someone came through.
- Catastrophizing: Treating any disappointment as a disaster.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling uneasy about needing someone and concluding it is unsafe.

Challenging questions

- Who failed me in the past, and are all people like them?
- Can I recall someone who was dependable?
- What does doing everything alone cost me?
- Could I depend on a person a little, in a small, low-risk way?
- Is there a difference between wise and foolish dependence?
- How has God been faithful when people were not?
- What would I tell a friend who was exhausted from carrying everything alone?

Truth summary

Some people have let me down, but not everyone will. I can depend on others carefully, a little at a time, and learn who is trustworthy. I can depend on God completely. Relying on others is not foolish when I choose wisely, and it can lighten what I was never meant to carry alone.

A short prayer

Lord, You are faithful when people are not. Heal the hurt of those who let me down. Teach me to rely on You first, and give me wisdom to find trustworthy people and the courage to lean on them a little. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Help
- Strength

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Communication
- Anxiety, Worry, Fear
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Trust in God
Elevation Worship feat. Chris Brown

Reflect on trusting God, who never fails.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember God's goodness as you learn to trust again.

Known
Tauren Wells

Rest in being known and cared for.

Truth Be Told
Matthew West & Carly Pearce

Practice honesty about the burdens you carry.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Extreme self-reliance often reflects early disappointment; graded, low-risk experiences of reliability are more helpful than arguing the belief away. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Is there one small thing I could let someone else help with today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Depending on anyone only leads to trouble."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Depending on anyone only leads to trouble." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you feel you must handle everything alone.

- ☐ Who failed me in the past, and are all people like them?
- ☐ Can I recall someone who was dependable?
- ☐ What does doing everything alone cost me?
- ☐ Could I depend on a person a little, in a small, low-risk way?
- ☐ Is there a difference between wise and foolish dependence?
- ☐ How has God been faithful when people were not?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Some people let me down, but not everyone will.
- ☐ I can depend on others a little at a time and learn who is trustworthy.
- ☐ I can depend on God fully.
- ☐ Asking for help is wise, not weak.
- ☐ I was not meant to carry everything alone.
- ☐ Trust can be built in small steps.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:12
  "And though one may be overpowered, two can resist. Moreover, a cord of three strands is not quickly broken."
- ☐ Proverbs 18:24
  "A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother."
- ☐ Psalm 62:8

"Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge."

☐ Galatians 6:2
"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Trust. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Ask someone safe for one small, specific favor, and notice what happens.
- ☐ Delegate one small task this week and observe the result.
- ☐ List three people who have kept their word to you.
- ☐ Share a minor difficulty with one trusted person, and record how they responded.
- ☐ Make a small plan with someone and see whether they follow through.
- ☐ Write a prayer thanking God for His faithfulness, then name one person you could trust a little more.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about trusting God and learning to trust again.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Depending on anyone only leads to trouble.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Some people failed me, but not all will. I can depend on God fully and on safe people a little at a time.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Ecclesiastes 4:9–10

A short prayer

Lord, thank You that You never fail me. Help me to lean on You first and to trust wise, safe people in small steps. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

"My feelings aren't worth sharing. Talking about them changes nothing."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you keep your feelings to yourself because sharing them seems pointless or like too much of a burden? Do you wonder whether anyone would really want to listen? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward sharing what is inside, and to find the relief that comes from knowing God's word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

When feelings were ignored, dismissed, or ridiculed in childhood, a person can learn that they do not matter and that talking about them makes no difference. In some families, feelings simply were not talked about. Over time, silence feels normal and sharing feels pointless.

How the belief can keep itself going

If feelings are never shared, no one has the chance to respond with care, so the person never learns that someone would listen. Unspoken feelings can also fade into numbness, which makes the belief seem true. A single safe experience of being heard can begin to change that.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture invites us to bring our feelings honestly to God. The Psalms are full of complaint, sorrow, and joy poured out before Him. We are also called to carry one another's burdens and to weep and rejoice together, and that cannot happen unless we share. These passages teach that our feelings matter to God and to the people He puts around us.

> *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ." (Galatians 6:2)*

Also see

> "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep." (Romans 12:15)

> "I pour out my complaint before Him; I reveal my trouble to Him." (Psalm 142:2)

> "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you." (1 Peter 5:7)

> "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail." (James 5:16)

Common self-statements

- No one wants to hear how I feel.
- Talking about it will not help.
- My feelings are not important.
- I would just be a burden.
- It is easier to keep everything inside.
- Why bother saying it? Nothing will change.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will care or understand.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how someone will react without asking.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring times when sharing helped.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that if talking cannot fix it, it is useless.
- Mislabeling: Calling myself a burden instead of a person with needs.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling numb and concluding that I have nothing worth saying.

Challenging questions

- Whose reaction in the past taught me that feelings do not matter?
- Have I ever shared something and felt better afterward?
- What does it cost me to keep everything inside?
- Does talking only matter if it fixes the problem, or can being heard help by itself?
- What would God want to hear from me?
- Who is one safe person I could tell one small feeling?
- If a friend carried what I carry, would I want them to tell me?

Truth summary

My feelings matter to God, and they can matter to the right people. Sharing does not always fix a problem, but being heard can lighten it. I can start small and choose safe people. God invites me to bring everything to Him, and He cares.

A short prayer

Lord, You hear every feeling I pour out. Help me bring them to You, and give me safe people who will listen. Teach me that I am not a burden, and that my heart matters to You. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Communication
- Help
- Friendship
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Anxiety, Worry, Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Truth Be Told
Matthew West & Carly Pearce

Reflect on the freedom of saying what is true.

Known
Tauren Wells

Rest in being fully known and loved.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Bring your feelings just as they are.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember God's goodness in the hard places.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Limited emotional expression may reflect temperament, learned family patterns, depression, or trauma; helping a person name even one feeling to one safe listener is a workable first step. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What am I feeling right now, and what could I tell God about it?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My feelings aren't worth sharing. Talking about them changes nothing."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "My feelings aren't worth sharing. Talking about them changes nothing." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you decide not to share how you feel.

- ☐ Whose reaction in the past taught me that feelings do not matter?
- ☐ Have I ever shared something and felt better afterward?
- ☐ What does it cost me to keep everything inside?
- ☐ Does talking only matter if it fixes the problem, or can being heard help by itself?
- ☐ What would God want to hear from me?
- ☐ Who is one safe person I could tell one small feeling?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ My feelings matter to God.
- ☐ Being heard can help even when nothing is fixed.
- ☐ I can start with one small feeling and one safe person.
- ☐ I am not a burden; I am a person with needs.
- ☐ God invites me to bring everything to Him.
- ☐ Some people will care, and I can learn who they are.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ Romans 12:15
  "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep."
- ☐ Psalm 142:2
  "I pour out my complaint before Him; I reveal my trouble to Him."

- [ ] 1 Peter 5:7
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."
- [ ] James 5:16
  "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Communication. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Write down one feeling each day for a week, even in a few words.
- ☐ Tell God one honest feeling in prayer, using Psalm 142:2 as a guide.
- ☐ Share one small feeling with a trusted person, and note how they responded.
- ☐ Ask a safe person, “Can I tell you something that has been on my mind?”
- ☐ Notice a time this week when you felt something and chose not to say it, and write what you feared.
- ☐ Choose a feelings word list and circle three words that fit your week.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about honesty, being heard, and God's care.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~My feelings aren't worth sharing. Talking about them changes nothing.~~

NEW TRUTH:
My feelings matter to God. Being heard can help, even when nothing is fixed. I can start small with a safe person.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Galatians 6:2

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for caring about what I feel. Help me to bring my heart to You and to share it with safe people, one step at a time. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #15 · CLOSENESS AND CONNECTION · NOT WORTH THE EFFORT

“Relationships take more than they give, so they aren’t worth the effort.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you sometimes feel that relationships take more from you than they give? Do you find yourself weighing what each person costs you? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward healthier, more balanced relationships, and to find the rest that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Someone who grew up caring for others, or in a home where closeness meant constant demands and little warmth, may learn that people take far more than they give. If the benefits of friendship were rarely experienced, the cost is all that is remembered.

How the belief can keep itself going

If the person invests little, relationships give little, and that seems to prove the belief. Time with draining people is counted, while unseen rewards are missed because they have never been tried. Looking at the whole picture, including what has been lost by staying away, can change the balance.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not hide the cost of love, but it tells us that giving is where blessing is found. Jesus said it is more blessed to give than to receive, and a generous person is refreshed. We are called to encourage one another and not neglect meeting together. These passages do not ignore draining relationships; they point to the fruit of well-chosen, mutual ones.

> *“And let us consider how to spur one another on to love and good deeds. Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another, and all the more as you see the Day approaching.” (Hebrews 10:24–25)*

Also see

> “In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: ‘It is more blessed to give than to receive.’” (Acts 20:35)

> “A generous soul will prosper, and he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed.” (Proverbs 11:25)

> “This is My commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you.” (John 15:12)

> “As good stewards of the manifold grace of God, each of you should use whatever gift he has received to serve one another.” (1 Peter 4:10)

Common self-statements

- People are exhausting.
- I give and give and get nothing back.

- It is not worth the energy.
- I have better things to do than keep up friendships.
- Relationships are more work than they are worth.
- I am better off with fewer demands.

Common logical errors

- Mental filter: Focusing on the costs and overlooking the benefits.
- Overgeneralizing: Concluding that all relationships are draining because some were.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing relationships as either fully rewarding or a waste.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing good moments as exceptions.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling tired and concluding that people are not worth it.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that new relationships will cost more than they give.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I think relationships cost, and what might they give?
- Which relationships, past or present, have been good for me?
- Have I ever invested in a relationship that was mutual and healthy?
- Is the problem relationships in general, or specific draining ones?
- What has staying away from people cost me?
- What does Scripture say about the blessing of giving and encouraging?
- How could I set limits so that relationships cost less but still give something?

Truth summary

Some relationships are draining, and I am allowed to set limits. But healthy, mutual relationships give comfort, laughter, help, and growth, and I may not have experienced much of that yet. I can choose wisely, give a little, and watch what comes back. God made relationships a source of blessing, not only of cost.

A short prayer

Lord, You know how tiring people have been for me. Heal what has been draining, and teach me healthy limits. Show me one relationship worth investing in, and let me discover the blessing You placed in it. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Church
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love

- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Reflect on God's goodness reaching you through others.

Known
Tauren Wells

Rest in being known and cared for.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Remember who you are in Christ as you choose who to invest in.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Come as you are; you need not earn your place.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. A cost-benefit view of relationships can reflect real past depletion; exploring what the person has actually received, and teaching limit-setting, avoids dismissing legitimate experiences. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Is there one person who gives me life, and could I spend a few minutes with them today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Relationships take more than they give, so they aren't worth the effort."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Relationships take more than they give, so they aren't worth the effort." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you think a relationship is not worth the effort.

- ☐ What exactly do I think relationships cost, and what might they give?
- ☐ Which relationships, past or present, have been good for me?
- ☐ Have I ever invested in a relationship that was mutual and healthy?
- ☐ Is the problem relationships in general, or specific draining ones?
- ☐ What has staying away from people cost me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the blessing of giving and encouraging?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Some relationships drain me, and others can renew me.
- ☐ I can set limits and still stay connected.
- ☐ Giving can bring blessing back.
- ☐ I may not have tried enough healthy relationships yet.
- ☐ Good relationships give comfort, laughter, and help.
- ☐ God made us to encourage one another.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Hebrews 10:24–25
  "And let us consider how to spur one another on to love and good deeds. Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another, and all the more as you see the Day approaching."
- ☐ Acts 20:35
  "In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: 'It is more blessed to give than to receive.'"
- ☐ Proverbs 11:25

"A generous soul will prosper, and he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed."

☐ John 15:12
"This is My commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you."

☐ 1 Peter 4:10
"As good stewards of the manifold grace of God, each of you should use whatever gift he has received to serve one another."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Friendship. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Make two lists about one relationship: what it costs and what it gives. Compare them honestly.
- ☐ Choose one person who has been good to you and spend a short, planned time with them.
- ☐ Do one small kind act for someone and notice how you feel afterward.
- ☐ Set one limit with a draining person, such as ending a call after twenty minutes.
- ☐ Attend one group or gathering for a short, set time, and note what you gained.
- ☐ Write a prayer thanking God for one person who has been a gift, and tell that person thank you.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about what relationships can give, and God's goodness through people.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Relationships take more than they give, so they aren't worth the effort.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Some relationships drain me, but healthy ones give far more than they take. I can set limits and still be connected.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Hebrews 10:24–25

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for the people who have blessed me. Help me to set healthy limits, to give wisely, and to receive the good You send through others. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

"What other people think of me doesn't matter."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you tell yourself that other people's opinions of you simply do not matter? Do praise and criticism both seem to slide right off you? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward valuing the honest voices of people who care about you, and to find the wisdom that comes from knowing God's word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Some people learn early that other people's opinions were unreliable, harsh, or impossible to please, so they decide to stop caring. Others have been hurt so often by criticism that indifference feels safer than hope. There is a healthy freedom from the fear of what people think. The belief goes too far when it shuts out the caring feedback and encouragement that make us wiser.

How the belief can keep itself going

Not caring what anyone thinks feels strong and protects against hurt. But it also means the person stops hearing honest feedback, kind words, and gentle correction from those who truly care. Without those voices, nothing challenges the belief, and distance can grow without anyone noticing.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture frees us from the fear of man: "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high." But it does not tell us to stop listening to people altogether. "The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel." "The wounds of a friend are faithful." "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another." We do not live for people's approval, but we are wiser when we receive the counsel of those who love us.

> *"The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel." (Proverbs 12:15)*

Also see

> "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high." (Proverbs 29:25)
>
> "The wounds of a friend are faithful, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful." (Proverbs 27:6)
>
> "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another." (Proverbs 27:17)
>
> "He who listens to life-giving reproof will dwell among the wise." (Proverbs 15:31)

Common self-statements

- I do not care what anyone thinks.
- Praise and criticism mean nothing to me.
- Their opinions are irrelevant.
- I set my own standards.
- No one's view of me affects me.
- I do not need anyone's approval or advice.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing the choice as either caring about everyone's opinion or no one's.
- Mislabeling: Calling hurt "indifference."
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring kind words and helpful feedback.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning a few unreliable critics into "no one's opinion counts."
- Selective attention: Remembering the criticism and forgetting the encouragement.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unaffected and concluding that I really do not care.

Challenging questions

- Is it true that I do not care at all, or did I learn not to show it?
- Whose opinion did I once care about, and what happened?
- Is there anyone whose honest view I could trust?
- What might I be missing by not hearing what caring people think?
- What is the difference between living for approval and being open to counsel?
- What does Scripture say about listening to wise people?
- If a friend told me their opinion of me did not matter, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

I do not have to live for anyone's approval, and I do not have to be ruled by criticism. But the honest voices of people who care about me are a gift. I can stay free of the fear of man and still listen to wise counsel and kind words.

A short prayer

Lord, I stopped caring what people think because it hurt too much. Set me free from the fear of man, and help me receive the wisdom and kindness of people who love me. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Humility
- Wisdom
- Friendship
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Voice of Truth
Casting Crowns

Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Who Am I
Casting Crowns

Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say
Lauren Daigle

God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Jesus Loves Me
Gaither Vocal Band

This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where indifference to praise and criticism is one feature of a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships. A healthy independence from other people's opinions is not a problem; the concern is a rigid conviction that no one's view matters, especially when it narrows life or costs the person support. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Whose caring voice could I listen to today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "What other people think of me doesn't matter."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "What other people think of me doesn't matter." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "What other people think of me doesn't matter."

- ☐ Is it true that I do not care at all, or did I learn not to show it?
- ☐ Whose opinion did I once care about, and what happened?
- ☐ Is there anyone whose honest view I could trust?
- ☐ What might I be missing by not hearing what caring people think?
- ☐ What is the difference between living for approval and being open to counsel?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about listening to wise people?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I can be free of the fear of man and still listen to those who care.
- ☐ Wise people listen to counsel.
- ☐ A friend's honest word is a gift.
- ☐ I do not live for approval, but I can receive encouragement.
- ☐ Kind words can matter to me.
- ☐ I can choose whose voice to trust.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Proverbs 12:15
  "The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel."
- ☐ Proverbs 29:25
  "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high."
- ☐ Proverbs 27:6
  "The wounds of a friend are faithful, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful."
- ☐ Proverbs 27:17
  "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another."

☐ Proverbs 15:31
“He who listens to life-giving reproof will dwell among the wise.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Humility. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ List three times someone's kind or honest words helped you, and note how it felt.
- ☐ Ask one trusted person for their honest view on something small, and record what happened.
- ☐ Accept a compliment with a simple "thank you," and notice your reaction.
- ☐ Tell someone one thing you appreciate about them.
- ☐ Notice a time this week when you cared more than you expected.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to help you receive the good words of others.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about what God says about you and whose voice you want to hear.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~What other people think of me doesn't matter.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I am free from the fear of man, and I can still receive wise counsel and kind words from people who care.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Proverbs 12:15

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for freeing me from the fear of man. Help me to listen to the wise and kind voices You place around me. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #17 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · GIVEN UP ON PEOPLE

“I’ve given up on letting people in.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Have you stopped trying to let people get close? Does it feel as though your shield is up for good and you no longer expect anything to change? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward opening the door, even a crack, and to find the hope that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Long seasons of disappointment, rejection, or loss can lead a person to quit trying. The shield that was once raised for protection becomes permanent, and the person may even feel relief at no longer hoping. Emotions can seem “switched off” because feeling them hurt too much. This is a way of coping, and it is often a sign of past pain, not of coldness.

How the belief can keep itself going

Giving up does protect from fresh disappointment, so the belief feels sensible. But a closed door cannot be tested, and so nothing new ever happens to change it. Hope deferred is painful, and the person may not notice how much has been lost: comfort, laughter, help, and being known.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that “hope deferred makes the heart sick,” but it also says, “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds,” and “A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish.” God is gentle with those who have given up. “Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another.” Giving up on people is understandable. Giving up on God’s ability to heal and restore is not necessary.

> *“A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice.” (Isaiah 42:3)*

Also see

> “Hope deferred makes the heart sick, but desire fulfilled is a tree of life.” (Proverbs 13:12)

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.” (Psalm 147:3)

> “Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor.” (Ecclesiastes 4:9)

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest.” (Matthew 11:28)

Common self-statements

- I am done trying.
- It never works out.
- I have shut that part of me off.
- I would rather not hope.
- Nothing will change.
- I do not feel anything anymore.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing it is either perfect closeness or none at all.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that every attempt will end in disappointment.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling numb and concluding that I no longer need anyone.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting a few painful relationships stand for everyone.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking small moments of warmth.
- Mislabeling: Calling protection "giving up."

Challenging questions

- What happened that led me to stop trying?
- Was there a time I let someone in and it went well, even a little?
- What have I lost since I closed the door?
- Is it possible to open it only a crack and only for someone safe?
- What does it mean that God does not break a bruised reed?
- What would my life look like with one safe friend?
- If a friend told me they had given up on people, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

My shield was built for good reasons, and I do not have to take it down all at once. God is gentle with bruised hearts. I can open the door a little, for someone safe, and let Him heal and restore what I thought was gone.

A short prayer

Lord, I have put up my shield and I am tired of hoping. You do not break bruised reeds. Heal what has been wounded, and help me open the door a little, to someone safe. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Depression, Symptoms of

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Just Be Held
Casting Crowns

God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm
Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham

Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope
Phil Wickham

Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance
Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither

This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where a person has "given up" on others and emotions are switched off. A permanent shield is often protective and rooted in earlier injury. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Who could I open the door to, just a crack, today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I've given up on letting people in."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I've given up on letting people in." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "I've given up on letting people in."

- ☐ What happened that led me to stop trying?
- ☐ Was there a time I let someone in and it went well, even a little?
- ☐ What have I lost since I closed the door?
- ☐ Is it possible to open it only a crack and only for someone safe?
- ☐ What does it mean that God does not break a bruised reed?
- ☐ What would my life look like with one safe friend?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ God is gentle with bruised hearts.
- ☐ I can open the door a little at a time.
- ☐ Hope can be rebuilt slowly.
- ☐ One safe person is a beginning.
- ☐ Giving up was protection, and I can choose differently.
- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Isaiah 42:3
  "A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice."
- ☐ Proverbs 13:12
  "Hope deferred makes the heart sick, but desire fulfilled is a tree of life."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor."

☐ Matthew 11:28
“Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Hopeless. Listen to Overcoming Depression. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ List three times someone showed you kindness, and note how it felt.
- ☐ Say hello to one person you would usually avoid, and stay for a minute.
- ☐ Send a short message to someone you have not spoken to in a while.
- ☐ Accept a small invitation, and stay a short, set time.
- ☐ Spend a few minutes noticing something good about one person.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to bring one safe person into your life.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being held, healed, and given hope.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I've given up on letting people in.~~

NEW TRUTH:
God is gentle with my bruised heart. I can open the door a little, to someone safe, and let Him restore what I thought was lost.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Isaiah 42:3

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for being gentle with me. Give me courage to open the door a little, and bring safe people into my life. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #18 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · CLOSENESS ISN'T IMPORTANT

"Close relationships aren't important to me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you feel that close relationships just are not important to you? Do you see little reason to be intimate with anyone? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward seeing how God made us for connection, and to find the joy that comes from knowing His word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

When earlier closeness brought pain, demands, or disappointment, a person may decide that intimacy is not worth the cost. Others genuinely feel little pull toward people, and over time they conclude that relationships do not matter. Family and friends may notice that the person has become emotionally distant, even in marriage, and that they seem unmoved by what once mattered.

How the belief can keep itself going

Not needing closeness feels tidy and low-maintenance. But the people around us, including spouses and children, may feel the distance, and the person misses what only relationships can give. Because the belief spares the person from the risk of closeness, it rarely gets tested.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is clear that relationship is part of how God made us. "It is not good for the man to be alone." "Love the Lord your God with all your heart... The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.'" Jesus said, "By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another." "A friend loves at all times." We were made to give and receive love. Even when closeness is hard, it matters to God, and learning to be close can be a gift for us and those who love us.

> *"The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'" (Genesis 2:18)*

Also see

> "By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another." (John 13:35)

> "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity." (Proverbs 17:17)

> "The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I do not need you.' Nor can the head say to the feet, 'I do not need you.'" (1 Corinthians 12:21)

> "We love because He first loved us." (1 John 4:19)

Common self-statements

- Intimacy is not important to me.
- I do not need anyone close.
- Relationships are not worth the effort.
- I am fine without a close connection.
- I am simply not a relational person.
- Others make too much of closeness.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning “I find closeness hard” into “closeness is unimportant.”
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing relationships as either intense or unnecessary.
- Mislabeling: Calling a fear of being hurt “not needing anyone.”
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring warm moments with others.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling little and concluding that nothing matters.
- Selective attention: Counting the costs of closeness and overlooking the gifts.

Challenging questions

- Have close relationships always felt unimportant, or did something change?
- What did closeness cost me in the past?
- What do the people who love me say they miss?
- What might I be missing by not letting anyone close?
- What does Scripture say about how God made us?
- Is there a kind of closeness that feels manageable, such as shared activities or conversation?
- If a friend told me close relationships do not matter to them, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

Close relationships matter to God, and they matter to the people who love me. If closeness has been painful or unnatural, I can move toward it slowly, in ways that fit me. I was made to love and be loved.

A short prayer

Lord, You made me for relationship, even when it feels unnatural. Soften my heart, show me the value of closeness, and help me love and be loved at a pace I can manage. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Loneliness
- Love for Others
- Marriage

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

If We Are the Body
Casting Crowns

The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

The God Who Stays
Matthew West

God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

I Am Not Alone
Kari Jobe

God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus
Keith and Kristyn Getty

This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where intimate relations are held to be unimportant. In clinical experience, a spouse may be the one who first notices the detachment. A preference for limited social contact is not itself a problem; the concern is a rigid conviction that closeness has no value, especially when it costs the person support or strains a marriage. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What small act of connection could I offer today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Close relationships aren't important to me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Close relationships aren't important to me." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "Close relationships aren't important to me."

- ☐ Have close relationships always felt unimportant, or did something change?
- ☐ What did closeness cost me in the past?
- ☐ What do the people who love me say they miss?
- ☐ What might I be missing by not letting anyone close?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about how God made us?
- ☐ Is there a kind of closeness that feels manageable, such as shared activities or conversation?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I was made for relationship.
- ☐ Love matters to God, and it matters to those who love me.
- ☐ Closeness can start small.
- ☐ I can move toward people at my own pace.
- ☐ I can give love, even if I do not feel it strongly.
- ☐ Connection can add to my life.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Genesis 2:18
  "The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'"
- ☐ John 13:35
  "By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another."
- ☐ Proverbs 17:17
  "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:21
  "The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I do not need you.' Nor can the head say to the feet, 'I do not need you.'"

☐ 1 John 4:19
“We love because He first loved us.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Friendship. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Ask someone you love what they enjoy doing together, and do it for a short time.
- ☐ Tell one person something you appreciate about them.
- ☐ Share a meal with someone and focus on listening.
- ☐ Ask your spouse or a close family member how you could be more present, and listen without defending.
- ☐ Spend a few minutes noticing what you enjoy about being with a particular person.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to teach you the value of love.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being made for connection and love.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Close relationships aren't important to me.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I was made for relationship. Closeness matters to God and to those who love me, and I can grow in it at my own pace.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Genesis 2:18

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for making me for relationship. Teach me to love and receive love at a pace I can manage. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #19 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · KEEPING THINGS PRIVATE

"I shouldn't confide in anyone."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you keep your thoughts and feelings to yourself because you do not want to confide in anyone? Does it feel safer to carry everything on your own? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward sharing with someone safe, and to find the relief that comes from knowing God's word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

A confidence that was betrayed, a childhood where private things were mocked or used against us, or a home where feelings were not welcome can teach us that keeping things to ourselves is the only safe way. Privacy is a healthy value. The belief goes too far when it becomes a rule that no one can be trusted with anything.

How the belief can keep itself going

Not confiding does keep us from being exposed, so the belief seems to work. But the person misses the comfort, perspective, and prayer that come from sharing, and carries everything alone. Because nothing is shared, the belief never meets a trustworthy listener.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors wise privacy: "A gossip reveals a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence." So safe people exist, and we can seek them. "The intentions of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out." "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed." And God Himself invites us: "Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge." We can begin with God, then share a little at a time with someone who has earned trust.

> *"Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge." (Psalm 62:8)*

Also see

> "A gossip reveals a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence." (Proverbs 11:13)

> "The intentions of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out." (Proverbs 20:5)

> "Oil and incense bring joy to the heart, and the sweetness of a friend is counsel to the soul." (Proverbs 27:9)

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ." (Galatians 6:2)

Common self-statements

- It is safer to keep things to myself.
- Nobody can be trusted with my secrets.
- Sharing only makes things worse.
- I should handle my own business.
- What I say will be used against me.
- Privacy is the only protection.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must tell everyone everything or tell no one anything.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that anything I share will be betrayed.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting one betrayal stand for everyone.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how a listener would react.
- Selective attention: Remembering broken confidences and forgetting kept ones.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling exposed and concluding that sharing is dangerous.

Challenging questions

- What happened that taught me not to confide?
- Has anyone ever kept something I shared? What happened?
- What is the difference between healthy privacy and carrying everything alone?
- What signs show that a person can be trusted?
- What could I tell God, who already knows everything?
- What small thing could I share first, and with whom?
- If a friend told me they could not confide in anyone, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

Privacy is wise, and so is finding a safe person to confide in. I can start with God, who hears everything, and share a little at a time with someone who has earned trust. I do not have to carry it all alone.

A short prayer

Lord, You know my heart. Teach me to pour it out to You, and to find one trustworthy person to share with. Keep me from carrying everything alone. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Confession
- Friendship
- Trust
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

He Knows
Jeremy Camp

Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Just Be Held
Casting Crowns

God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

I Am Not Alone
Kari Jobe

God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus
Keith and Kristyn Getty

This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where confiding in others is avoided. Many clients have a history of breached confidences, so trust must be earned in session; clear explanations of confidentiality and its limits help. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What could I tell God, and who might be safe to tell next?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I shouldn't confide in anyone."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I shouldn't confide in anyone." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "I shouldn't confide in anyone."

- ☐ What happened that taught me not to confide?
- ☐ Has anyone ever kept something I shared? What happened?
- ☐ What is the difference between healthy privacy and carrying everything alone?
- ☐ What signs show that a person can be trusted?
- ☐ What could I tell God, who already knows everything?
- ☐ What small thing could I share first, and with whom?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I can pour out my heart to God.
- ☐ Trustworthy people keep confidences.
- ☐ I can share a little at a time.
- ☐ Privacy and sharing can both be wise.
- ☐ I do not have to carry everything alone.
- ☐ A friend's counsel is sweet to the soul.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Psalm 62:8
  "Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge."
- ☐ Proverbs 11:13
  "A gossip reveals a secret, but a trustworthy person keeps a confidence."
- ☐ Proverbs 20:5
  "The intentions of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out."
- ☐ Proverbs 27:9
  "Oil and incense bring joy to the heart, and the sweetness of a friend is counsel to the soul."

☐ Galatians 6:2
“Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Confession. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Write a letter to God telling Him everything on your heart.
- ☐ List the safest people you know and what makes them safe.
- ☐ Share one small, low-risk thing with a safe person, and note how they responded.
- ☐ Ask a trusted person what helps them feel safe confiding in others.
- ☐ Notice a time someone kept your confidence.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to bring one trustworthy listener into your life.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being known by God and held in His care.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I shouldn't confide in anyone.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I can pour out my heart to God and, in time, share a little with someone safe. I do not have to carry it all alone.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Psalm 62:8

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for hearing everything. Give me a trustworthy listener, and help me share a little at a time. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #20 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · NOTHING IS ENJOYABLE

“Nothing is much fun anyway, so I might as well be on my own.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you find that little brings you pleasure, so you wonder why you should bother with other people? Have activities that once felt enjoyable lost their spark? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward rediscovering joy, and to find the gladness that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Sometimes the capacity for enjoyment fades. This can follow long stress, loss, depression, or years of keeping people at a distance, and sometimes a person has simply always been somewhat quiet and low-key. When fun fades, the reasons for joining others fade with it, and being alone becomes the default.

How the belief can keep itself going

If nothing feels enjoyable, staying home seems reasonable. But less activity and less company usually mean even fewer enjoyable experiences, which confirms the belief. Enjoyment often returns slowly, after we do things, not before.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture treats joy as one of God’s gifts. “You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence.” God “richly provides all things for us to enjoy.” “There is nothing better for them than to rejoice and do good while they live… this is the gift of God.” “A joyful heart is good medicine, but a broken spirit dries up the bones.” If joy has faded, it may be a signal to care for the body and heart, seek help, and slowly try small things with safe people.

> *“You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand.” (Psalm 16:11)*

Also see

> “Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy.” (1 Timothy 6:17)

> “A joyful heart is good medicine, but a broken spirit dries up the bones.” (Proverbs 17:22)

> “You turned my mourning into dancing; You peeled off my sackcloth and clothed me with joy, that my heart may sing Your praises and not be silent.” (Psalm 30:11–12)

> “Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor.” (Ecclesiastes 4:9)

Common self-statements

- Nothing is fun anymore.
- I do not enjoy anything.
- Why bother going out?
- I am happier on my own.
- Social events are a waste of time.
- I do not feel much of anything.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Feeling flat and concluding that nothing could be enjoyable.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing something is either thrilling or pointless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that an activity will not be enjoyable.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking small pleasures when they happen.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning “this was dull” into “nothing is fun.”
- Selective attention: Counting the letdowns and overlooking the pleasant moments.

Challenging questions

- What did I enjoy in the past, and when did it fade?
- Has anything brought even a little pleasure recently?
- What happens to my mood when I stay home all the time?
- Could stress, tiredness, or low mood be dimming my enjoyment?
- What small activity could I try, even if I do not expect to enjoy it?
- What does Scripture say about joy as a gift?
- If a friend told me nothing was fun anymore, what would I suggest?

Truth summary

Joy is a gift from God, and it can return, often slowly. When enjoyment fades, I can care for my health, try small things, and spend time with safe people, even before I feel like it. Being alone is not the only option, and I do not have to settle for a flat life.

A short prayer

Lord, You are the giver of joy. Restore my capacity to enjoy what You have given, and lead me gently toward people and activities that bring me gladness. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Joy
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Loneliness
- Thankful

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Thinking, Healthy
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Already There
Casting Crowns

God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive
Casting Crowns

Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Living Hope
Phil Wickham

Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness
CeCe Winans

This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where infrequent participation in activities for fun or pleasure is one feature. Reduced pleasure (anhedonia) is also a core feature of depression, so screen for depression and, when indicated, suicide risk; refer for evaluation if enjoyment has recently declined, if sleep or appetite have changed, or if there are thoughts of self-harm (in the U.S., call or text 988). This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What small, pleasant thing could I try today, even if I do not expect to enjoy it?"

My Plan for Replacing "Nothing is much fun anyway, so I might as well be on my own."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Nothing is much fun anyway, so I might as well be on my own." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "Nothing is much fun anyway."

- ☐ What did I enjoy in the past, and when did it fade?
- ☐ Has anything brought even a little pleasure recently?
- ☐ What happens to my mood when I stay home all the time?
- ☐ Could stress, tiredness, or low mood be dimming my enjoyment?
- ☐ What small activity could I try, even if I do not expect to enjoy it?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about joy as a gift?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Joy is a gift from God.
- ☐ Enjoyment can return.
- ☐ Small steps can bring gladness.
- ☐ Being active often brings back pleasure.
- ☐ I do not have to settle for a flat life.
- ☐ Company can add to my joy.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Psalm 16:11
  "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand."
- ☐ 1 Timothy 6:17
  "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy."
- ☐ Proverbs 17:22
  "A joyful heart is good medicine, but a broken spirit dries up the bones."

- [ ] Psalm 30:11–12
  "You turned my mourning into dancing; You peeled off my sackcloth and clothed me with joy, that my heart may sing Your praises and not be silent."
- [ ] Ecclesiastes 4:9
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Joy. Listen to Overcoming Depression. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Make a list of things you enjoyed in the past, and try one for ten minutes.
- ☐ Rate your mood before and after a short walk or outing.
- ☐ Do one small thing you used to enjoy, whether or not you feel like it, and note what happens.
- ☐ Invite a safe person to join you in a simple activity.
- ☐ Notice and write down one pleasant moment each day.
- ☐ Write a prayer thanking God for one good thing and asking for more joy.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about joy and God's goodness.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Nothing is much fun anyway, so I might as well be on my own.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Joy is a gift, and it can return. I can take small steps toward people and activities, even before I feel like it.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Psalm 16:11

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for the gift of joy. Restore it in me, and lead me gently toward people and things that bring me gladness. Amen.

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